Section: 7. String and its Methods

Lecture: 75. Joining and Splitting a String

Section 1: Lecture Summary

This lecture covers several important string methods in Python: replace(), join(), split(), rsplit(), and splitlines(). The instructor explains how each method works conceptually and demonstrates practical examples in a Jupyter Notebook environment. The replace() method is used to substitute old substrings with new ones, optionally limiting the number of replacements. The join() method inserts a given separator string between all elements of an iterable (typically a string or list of strings) to create a new concatenated string. The split() method divides a string into a list of substrings based on a specified separator and supports limiting the number of splits. The rsplit() method is similar but splits starting from the right side. The splitlines() method handles splitting multi-line strings into individual lines. The lecture emphasizes that strings are immutable; hence, these methods return new strings or lists without modifying the original string. Students are encouraged to practice by trying various examples to solidify their understanding.

Section 2: Key Concepts and Explanations

- **String Immutability**

  - Strings cannot be changed once created.

  - Methods that modify strings return new string objects.

- **replace(old, new, count)**

  - Replaces occurrences of the substring `old` with `new`.

  - `count` is optional; limits how many occurrences to replace.

  - If `old` substring is not found, returns the original string unchanged.

- Example: Replace hyphens with commas.

- Useful for text manipulation and format changes.

- **join(iterable)**

- Inserts the string on which join() is called between elements of an iterable (usually a list or string).

- Returns a new concatenated string.

- Does not add the separator after the last element.

- Example: `'/' .join('ABC')` results in `'A/B/C'`.

- Useful for constructing strings from lists or sequences.

- **split(sep=None, maxsplit=-1)**

- Splits the string into a list of substrings using `sep` as the delimiter.

- Default separator is whitespace if `sep` is None.

- `maxsplit` limits the number of splits performed; remaining string is kept as last element.

- Returns a list of substrings.

- Examples include splitting on space, letters, commas, or hyphens.

- If the separator is not found, the returned list contains the original string as its only element.

- **rsplit(sep=None, maxsplit=-1)**

- Works like split() but starts splitting from the right (end) of the string.

- Useful when you want to split a fixed number of times from the end.

- **splitlines(keepends=False)**

- Splits a multi-line string at line boundaries into a list of lines.

- Returns each line as a separate string.

- `keepends` parameter (not covered in detail) can optionally keep newline characters in the resulting list.

- Useful for processing multi-line text.

Section 3: Example Code and Use Cases

replace() method examples

Replace all hyphens with commas

Replace only first three hyphens with commas

Replace a substring not found in string (no change)

Replace domain in email string

```
s1 = 'a-b-c-d-e'
s2 = s1.replace('-', ',')
print(s2)  # Output: a,b,c,d,e

s2 = s1.replace('-', ',', 3)
print(s2)  # Output: a,b,c,d-e

s2 = s1.replace('k', 'm')
print(s2)  # Output: a-b-c-d-e

email = 'abcd@gmail.com'
new_email = email.replace('gmail', 'yahoo')
print(new_email)  # Output: abcd@yahoo.com
```

Explanation: Demonstrates replacing characters and substrings with optional count limiting, and illustrates that no change occurs if target substring is absent.

join() method examples

Insert s1 string between characters of s2

Another example using '/'

```
s1 = 'xyz'
s2 = 'ABC'
```

```
s3 = s1.join(s2)
print(s3)  # Output: AxyzBxyzC

separator = '/'
s3 = separator.join(s2)
print(s3)  # Output: A/B/C
```

Explanation: Shows how join inserts the separator string between iterable elements in a new string.

split() method examples

Split by default separator (space)

Split by character 'h'

Split by comma

Split by hyphen with maxsplit limiting splits

```
s1 = 'John Smith Ajay'

s2 = s1.split()
print(s2)  # Output: ['John', 'Smith', 'Ajay']

s2 = s1.split('h')
print(s2)  # Output: ['Jo', 'n Smit', ' Ajay']

s3 = 'John,Smith,Ajay'
s2 = s3.split(',')
print(s2)  # Output: ['John', 'Smith', 'Ajay']

s4 = 'John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james'
s2 = s4.split('-', 3)
print(s2)  # Output: ['John', 'Smith', 'Ajay', 'khan-james']
```

Explanation: Shows splitting by various delimiters and with limit on number of splits, producing lists of substrings.

rsplit() example

Split 3 times from right

```
s = 'John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james'

s2 = s.rsplit('-', 3)
print(s2)  # Output: ['John', 'Smith', 'Ajay', 'khan', 'james']
```

Explanation: Demonstrates splitting from the right side, useful for processing suffixes.

splitlines() example

```
multiline_str = "Line 1\nLine 2\nLine 3"
lines = multiline_str.splitlines()
print(lines)  # Output: ['Line 1', 'Line 2', 'Line 3']
```

Explanation: Splits a multi-line string into individual lines.

Section 4: Key Takeaways

- String methods like replace(), join(), split(), rsplit(), and splitlines() are powerful tools for text manipulation in Python.

- All these methods return new strings or lists; they do not modify the original string due to string immutability.

- The replace() method can replace all or a limited count of occurrences of a substring.

- The join() method concatenates a sequence inserting the separator string only between elements.

- The split() method divides strings on a delimiter into lists, with optional limits on splits.

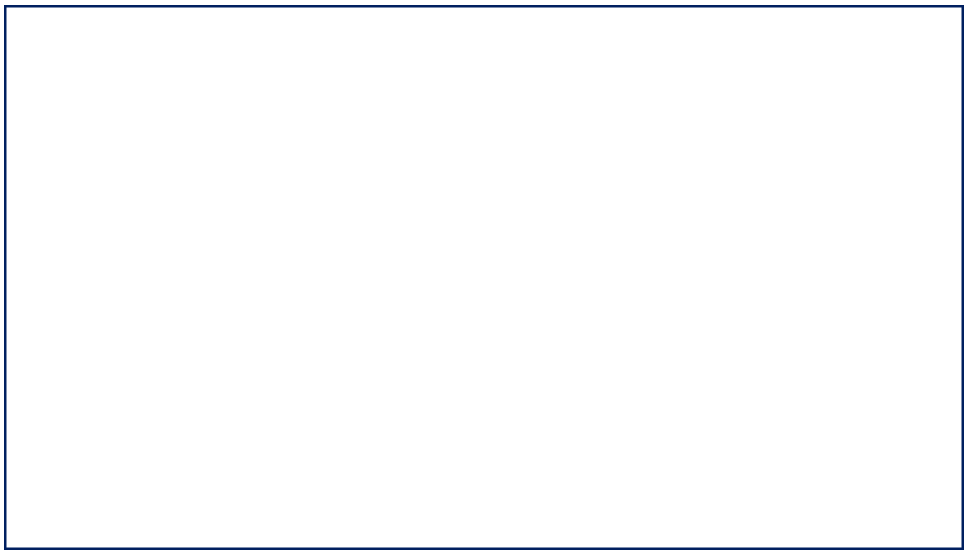
- rsplit() does split operations starting from the right side of the string.

- splitlines() efficiently splits multi-line text into a list of lines.

- Understanding and practicing these methods is essential for effective string handling in Python programming and application development.

Lecture in Slides

Please Note: This document presents a curated selection of slides from the lecture; others have been excluded for conciseness.

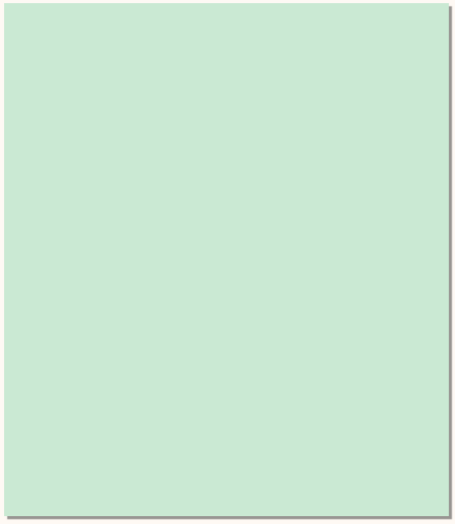



Join & Split


Join & Split
String Methods

Join & Split

String Methods



Join & Split

String Methods

replace(old, new, count)

Join & Split

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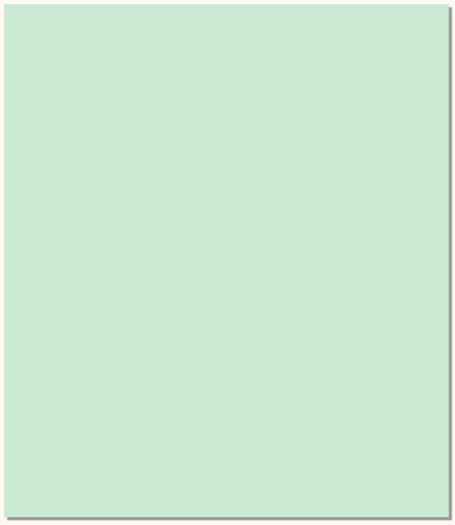

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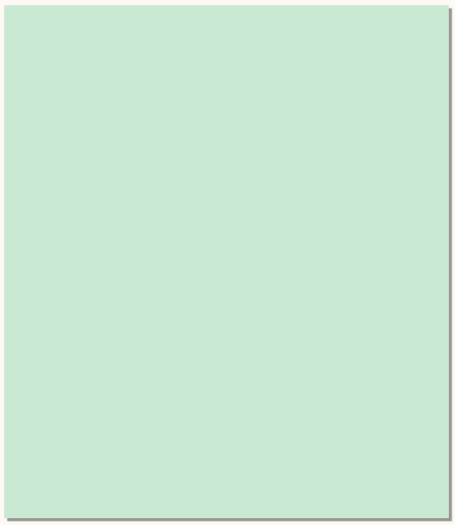

replace(old, new, count)

join(iterable)

Join & Split

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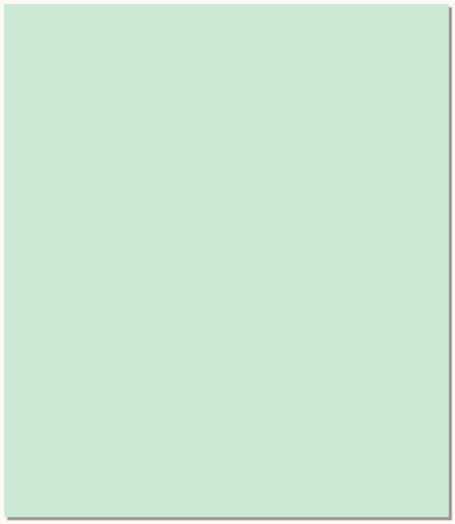

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/	s1	a	b	c

Join & Split

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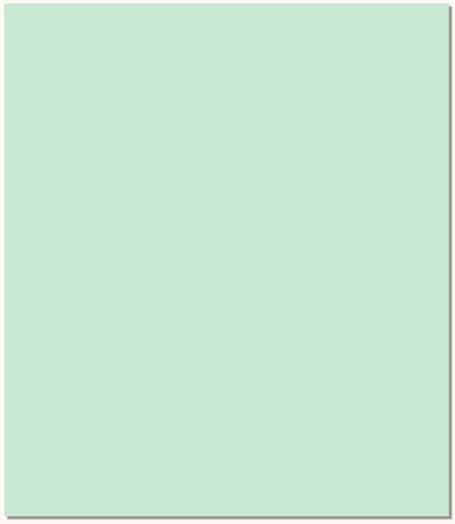

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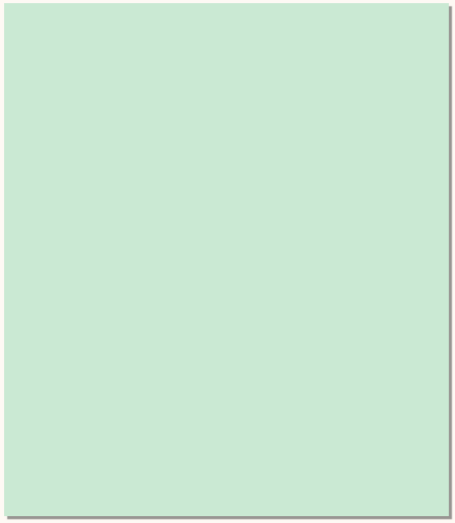

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split(sep, maxsplit)

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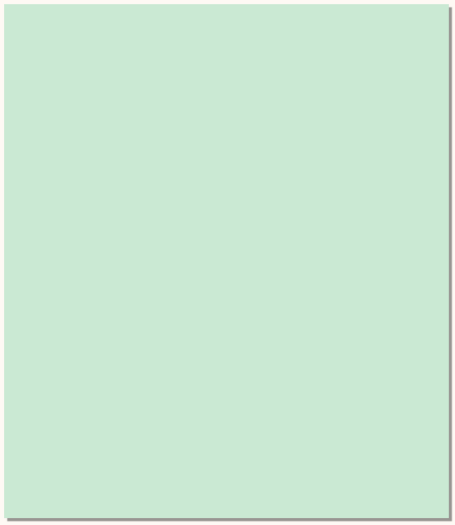

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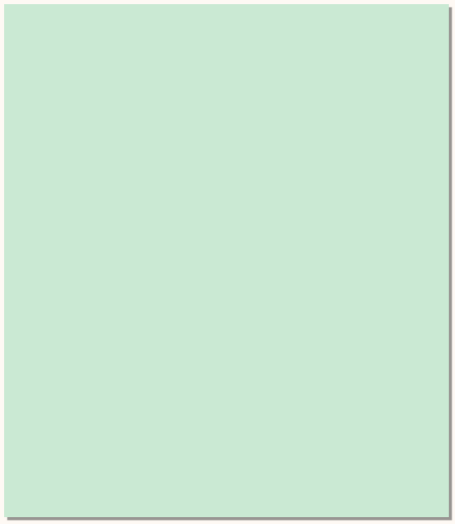

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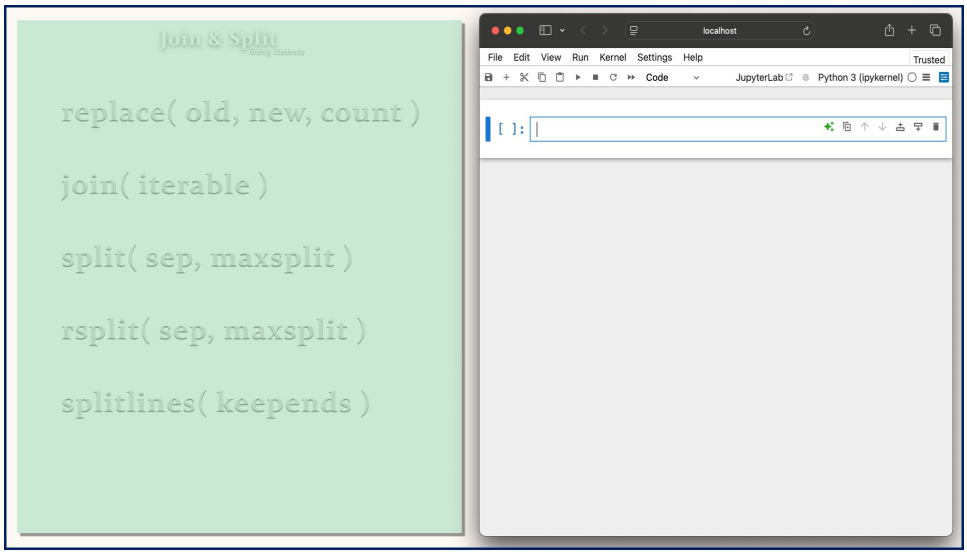
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Python 3 (ipykernel)
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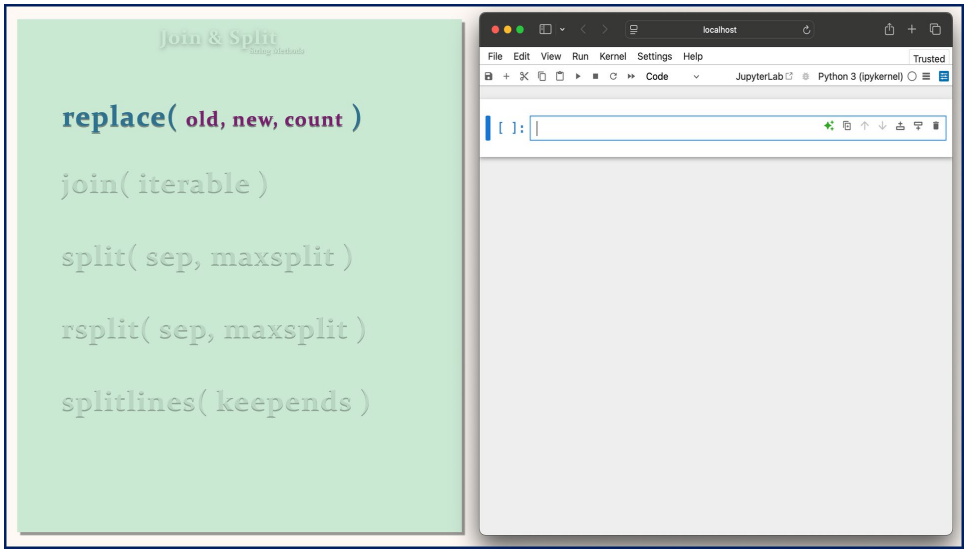
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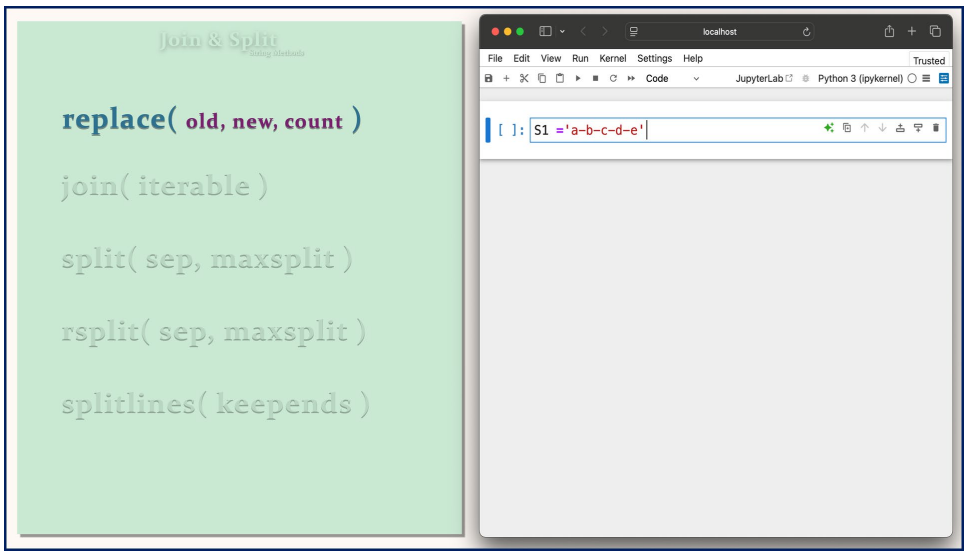
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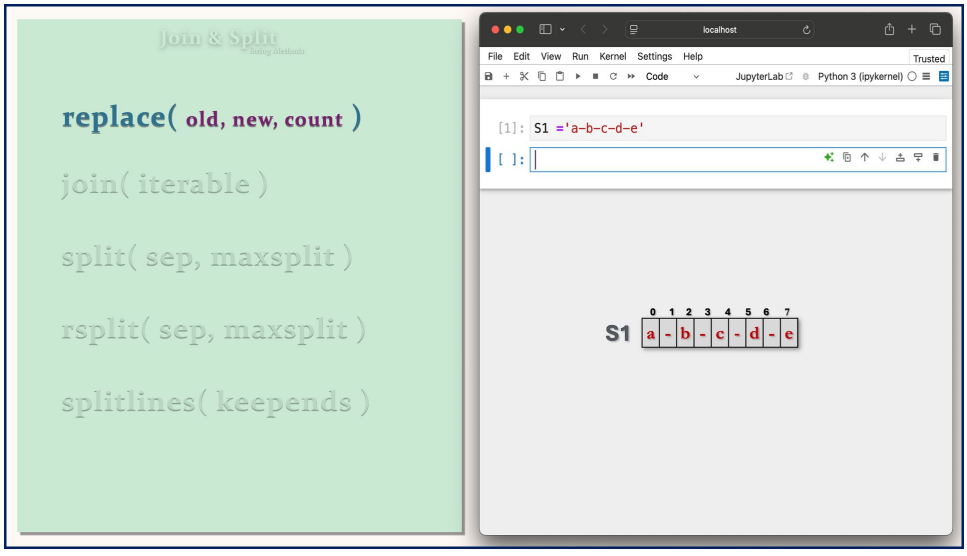
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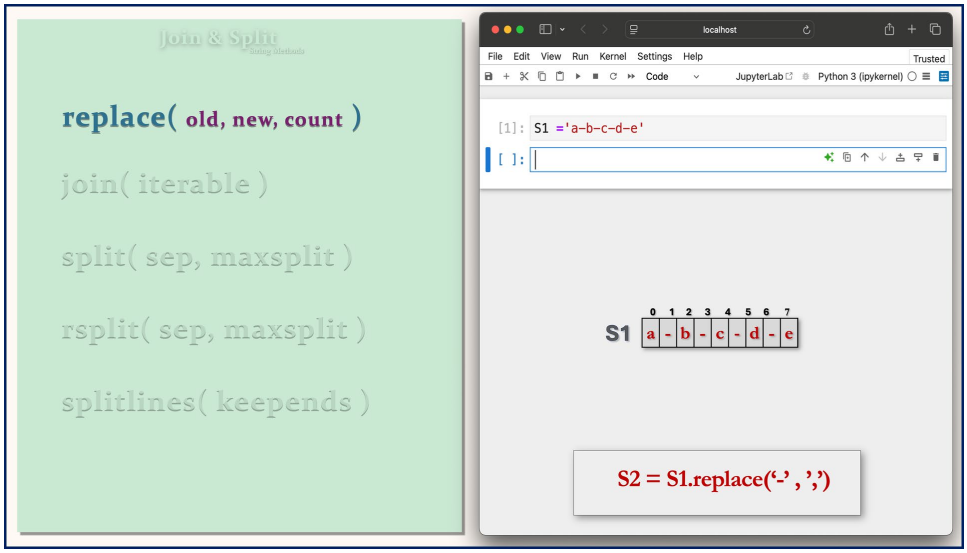
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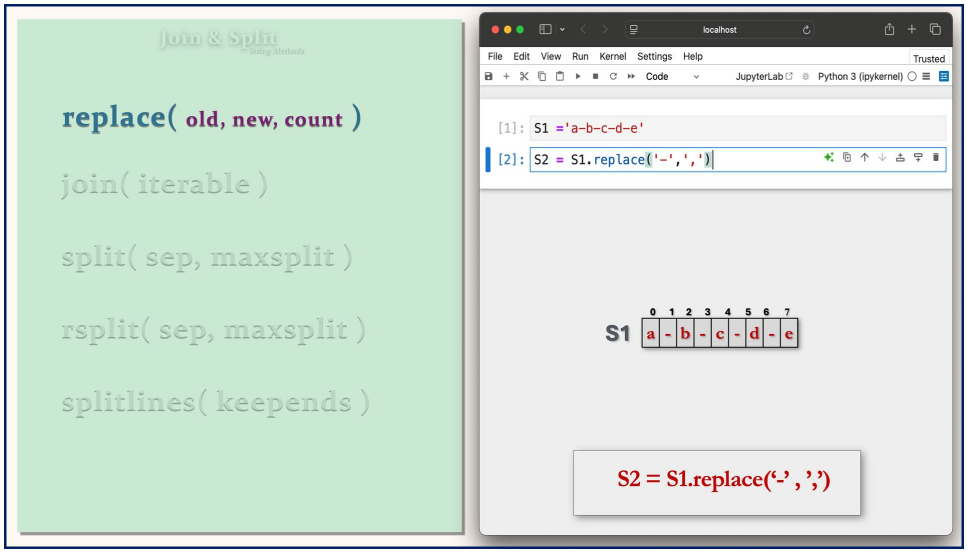
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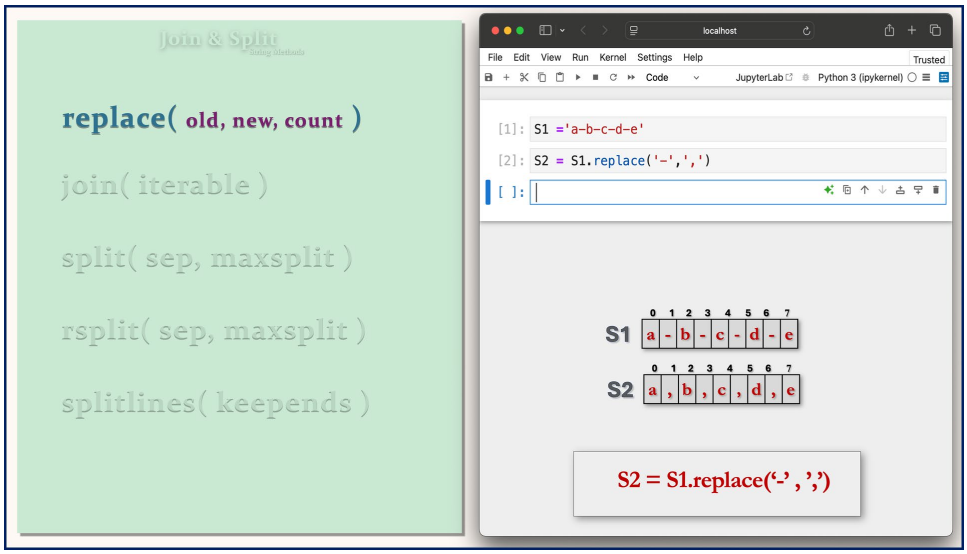
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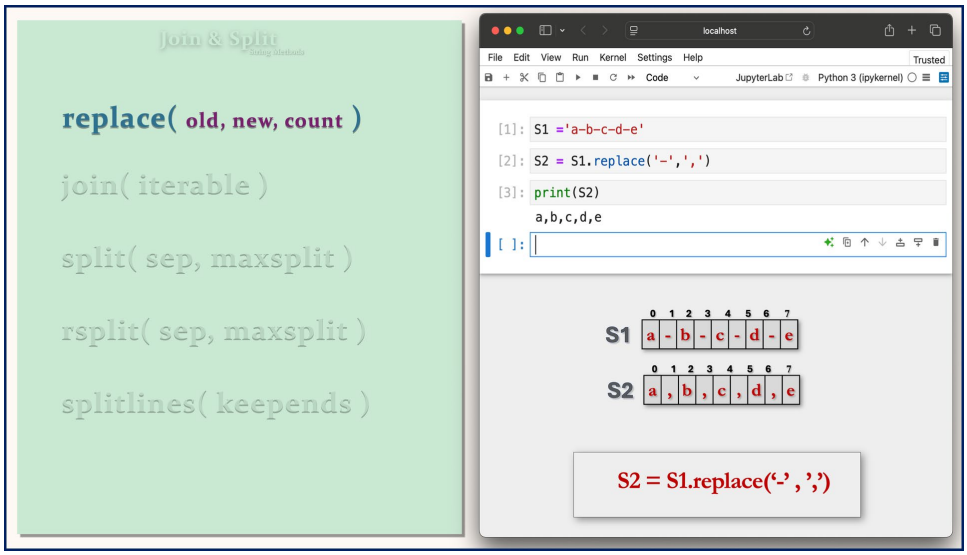
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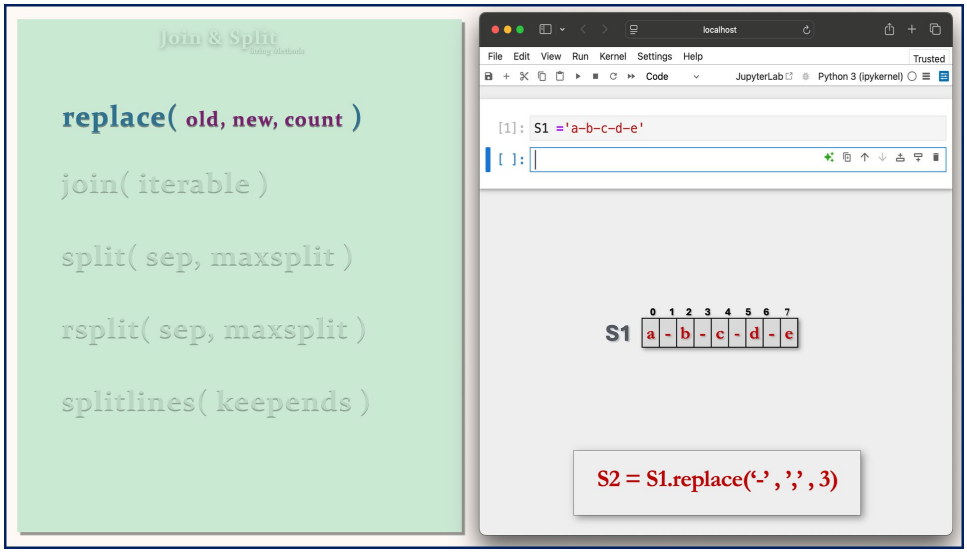
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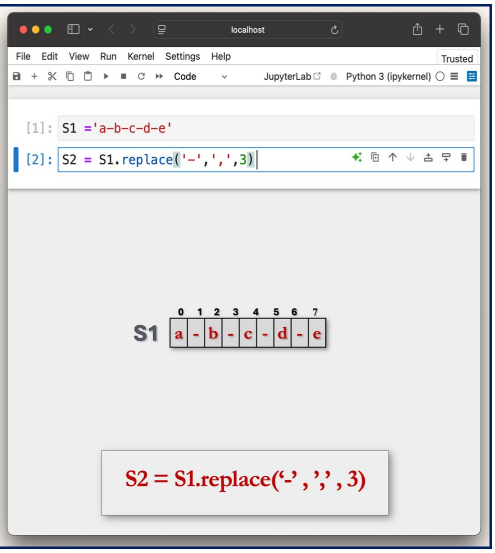

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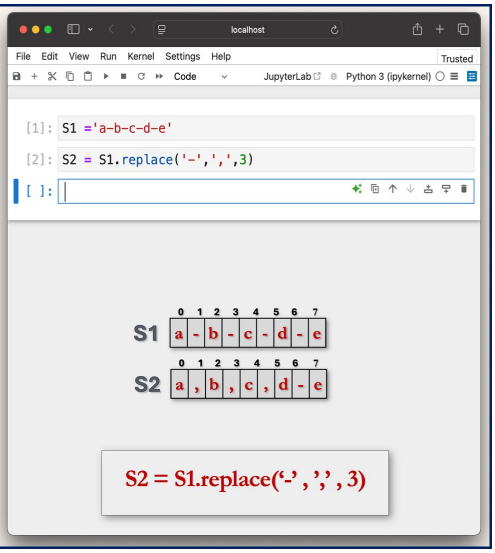

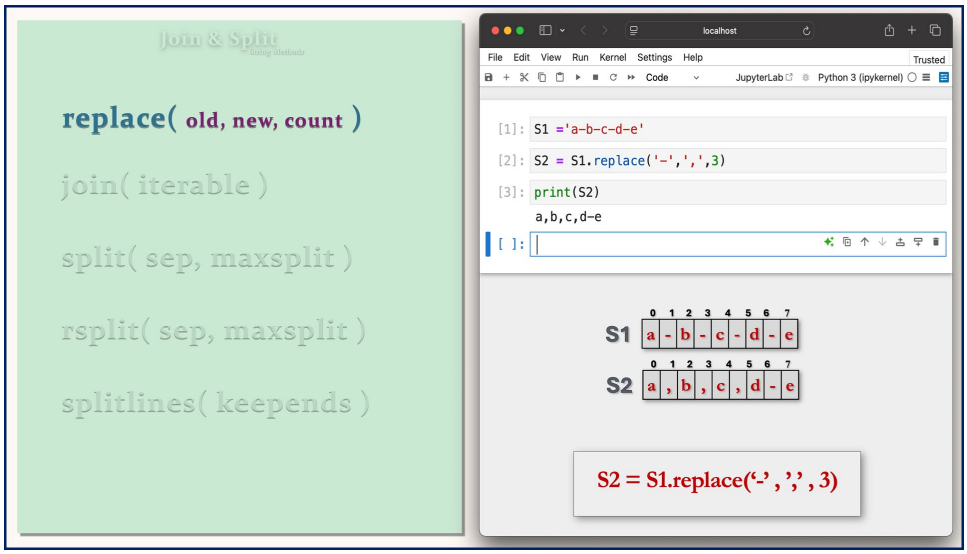
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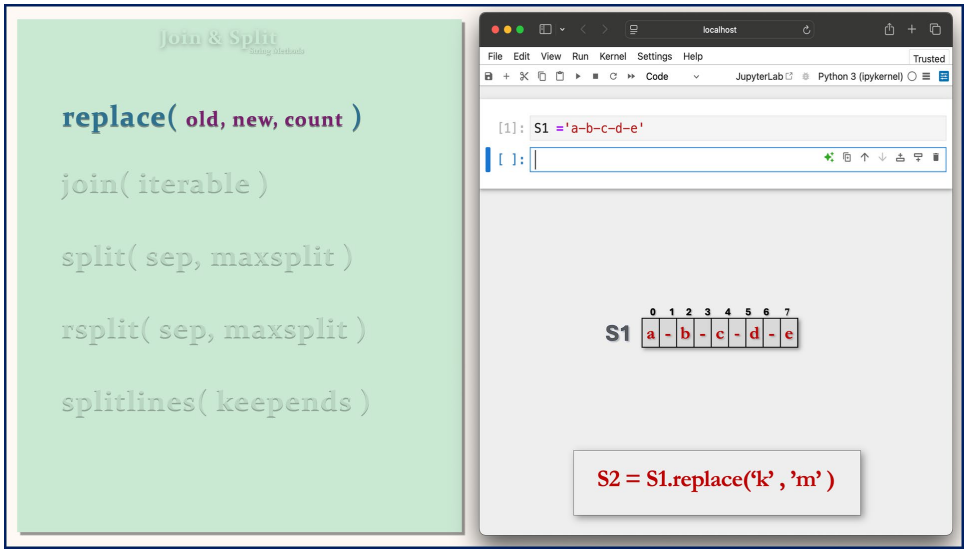
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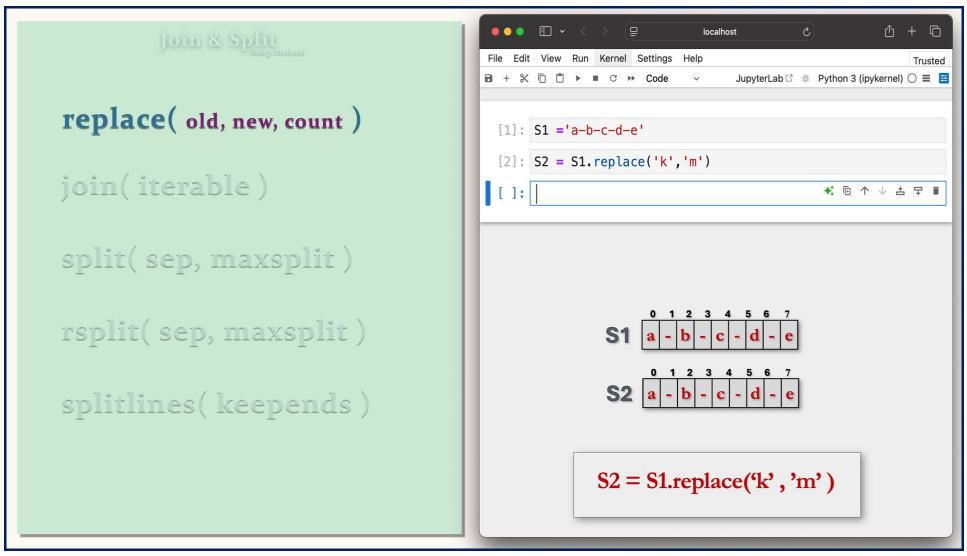
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[2]: S2 = S1.replace('k','m')
[ ]:
S1
S2
0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7
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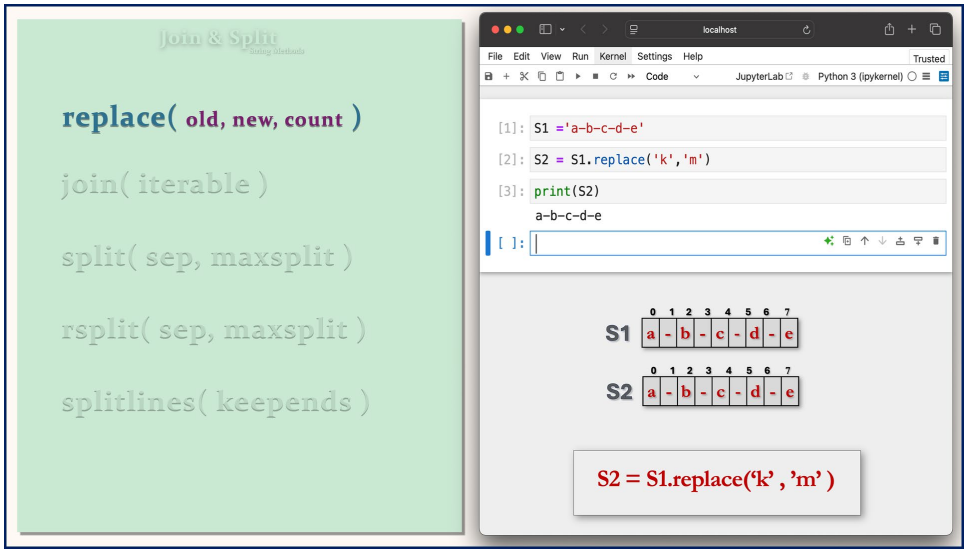
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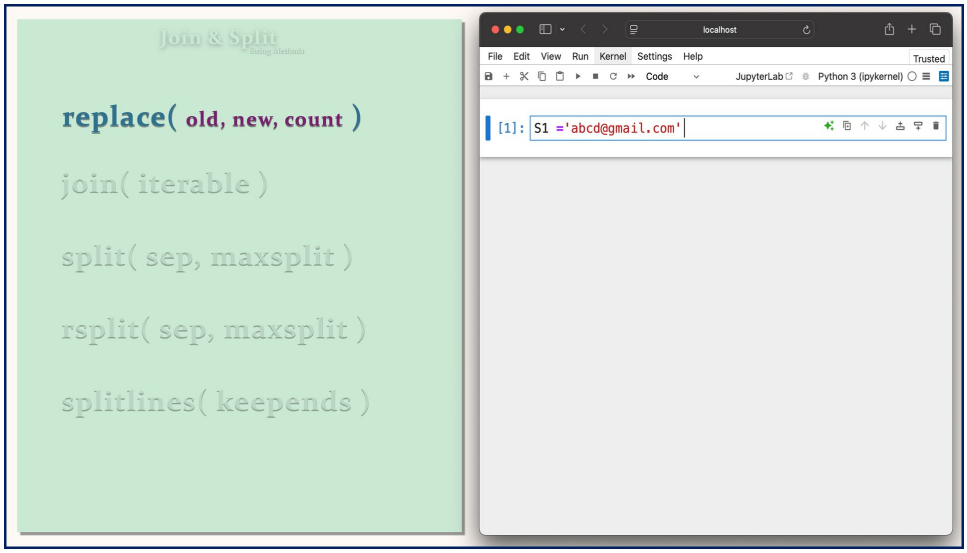
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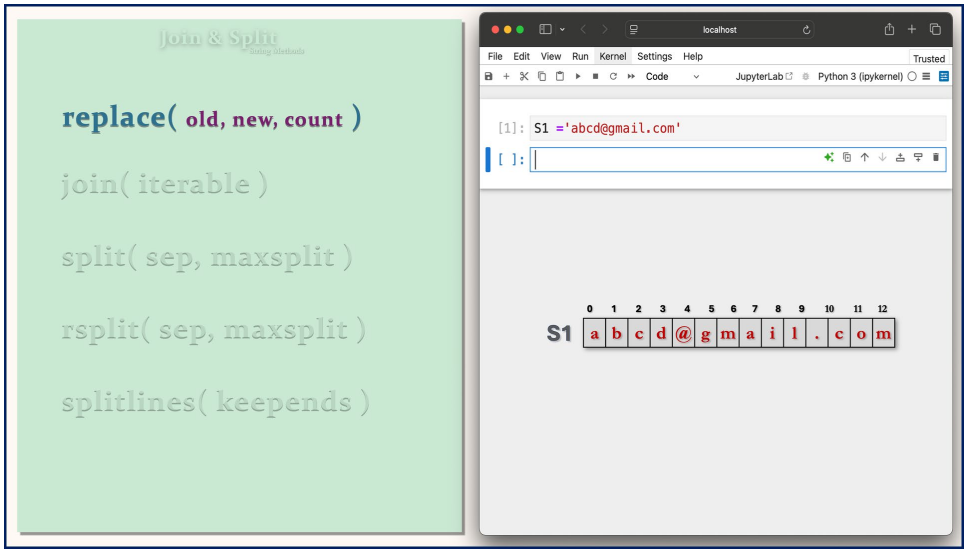
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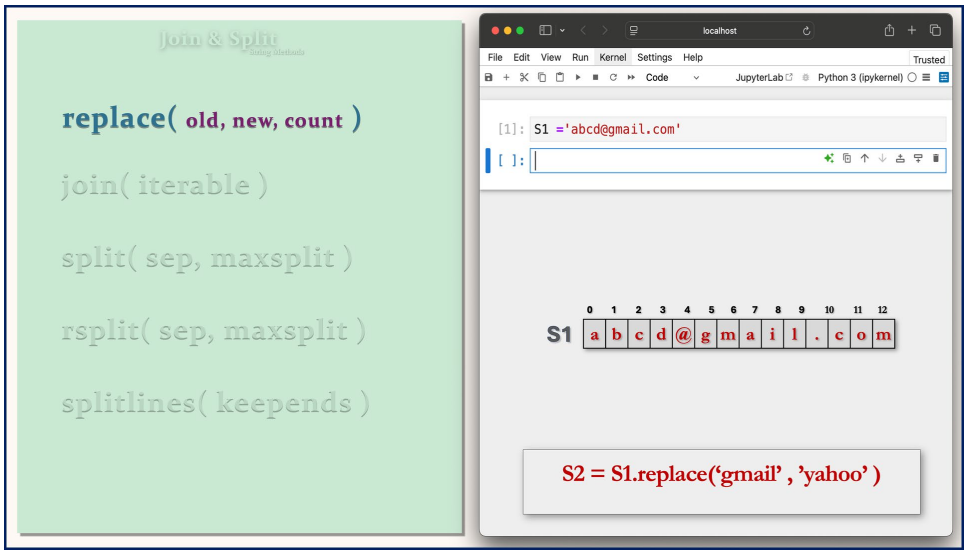
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 ='abcd@gmail.com'
[ ]:
S1
0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12
a b c d @ g m a i l . c o m


Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
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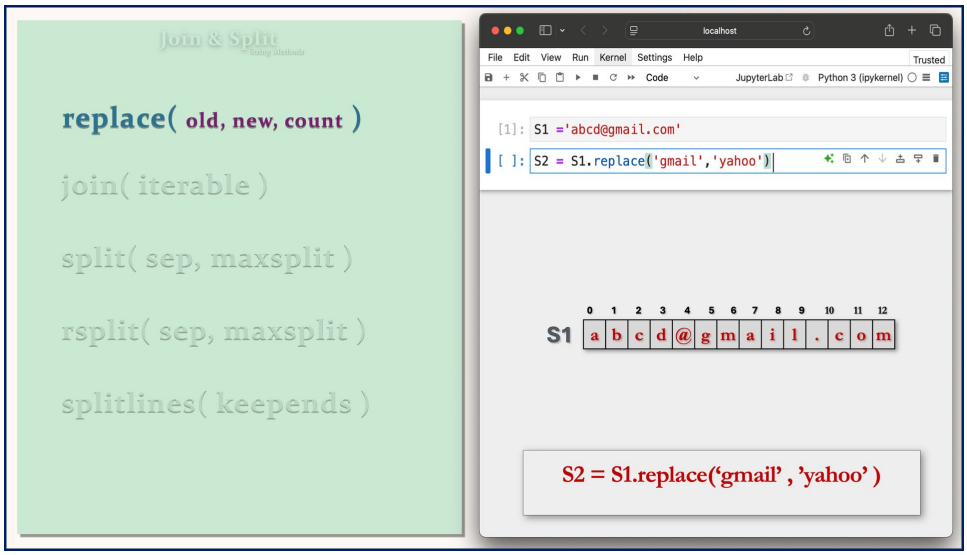
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 ='abcd@gmail.com'
[ ]:
S1
0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12
a b c d @ g m a i l . c o m
S2 = S1.replace('gmail' , 'yahoo')


Join & Split
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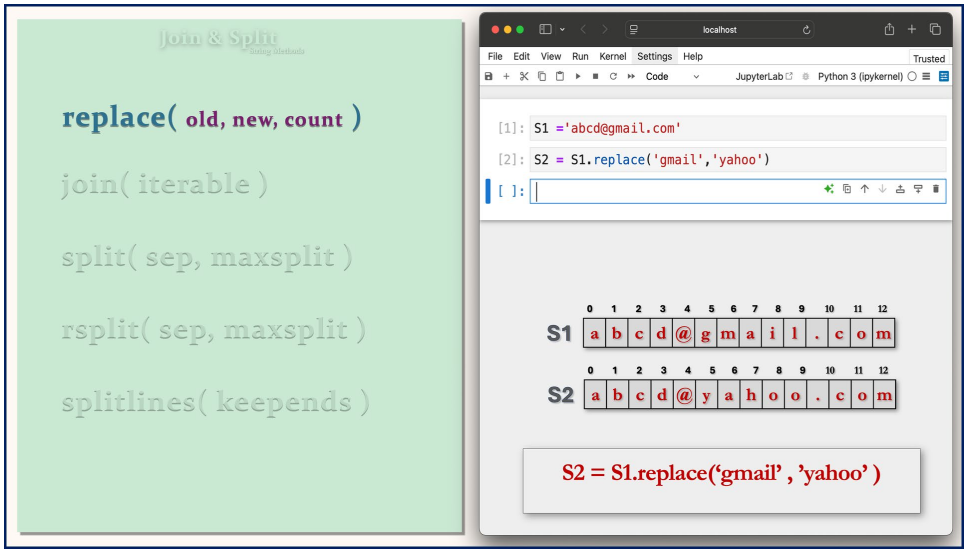
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 ='abcd@gmail.com'
[ ]: S2 = S1.replace('gmail','yahoo')
S1
0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12
a b c d @ g m a i l . c o m
S2 = S1.replace('gmail' , 'yahoo')


Join & Split
String Methods
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join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
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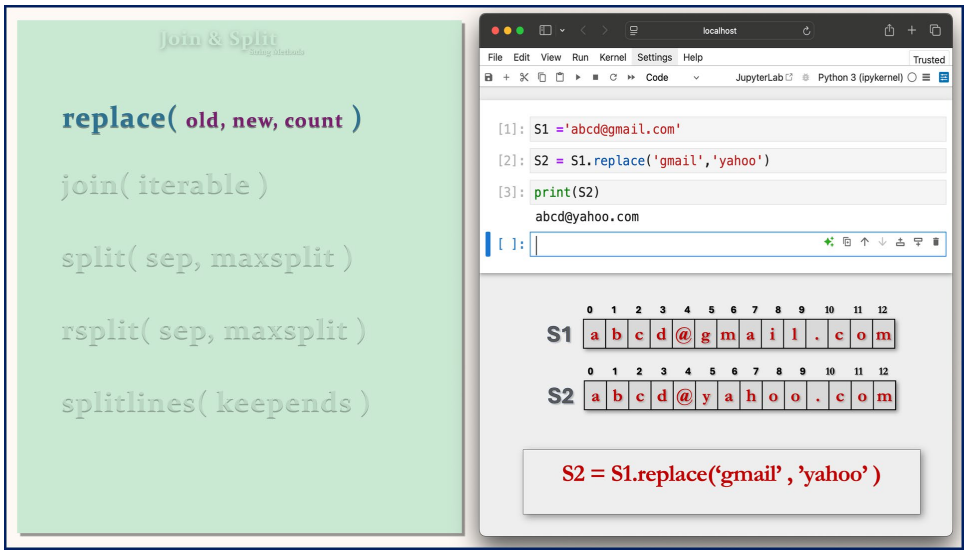
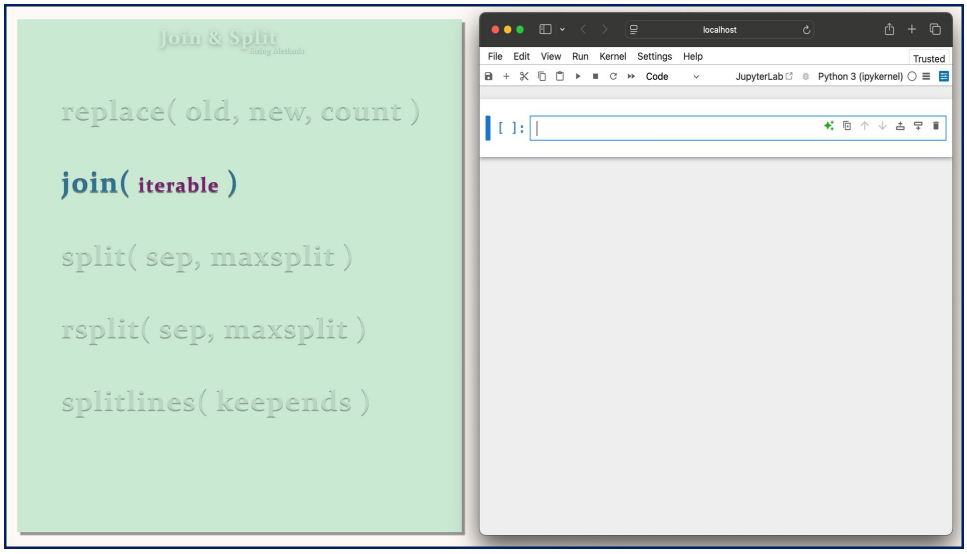
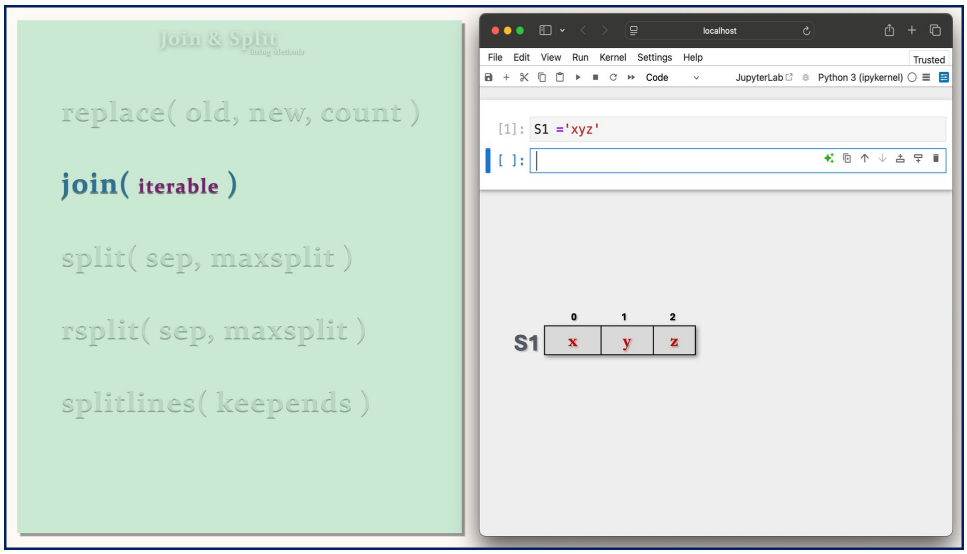
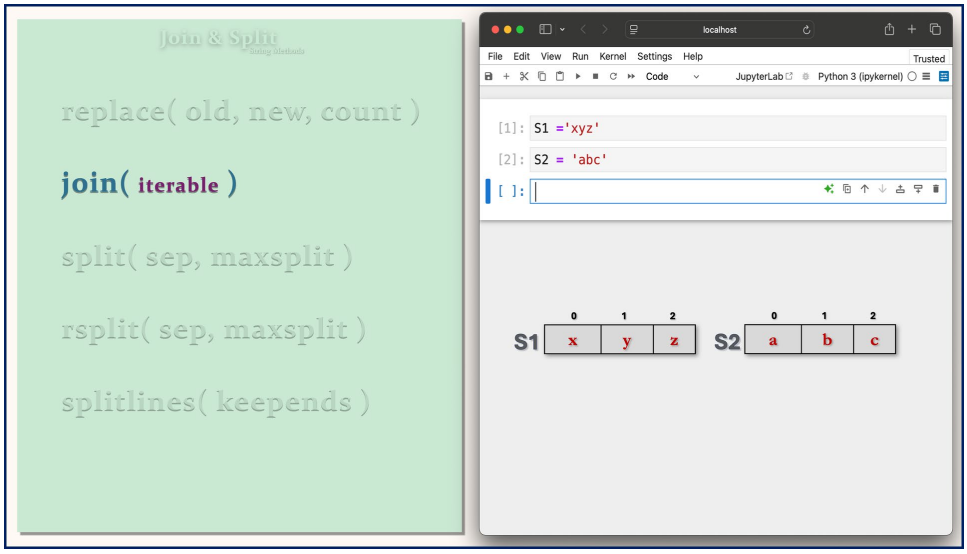
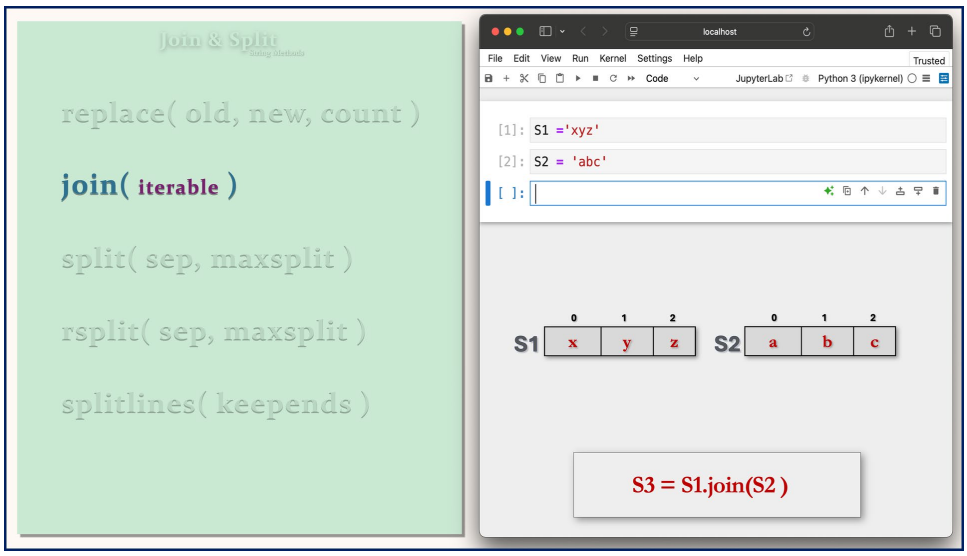
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 ='abcd@gmail.com'
[2]: S2 = S1.replace('gmail','yahoo')
[ ]:
S1
S2
S2 = S1.replace('gmail' , 'yahoo')


Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 ='abcd@gmail.com'
[2]: S2 = S1.replace('gmail','yahoo')
[3]: print(S2)
abcd@yahoo.com
[ ]:
S1
S2
S2 = S1.replace('gmail' , 'yahoo')


Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[ ]:


Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 ='xyz'
[ ]:
0 1 2
S1 x y z


Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 ='xyz'
[2]: S2 = 'abc'
[ ]:
0 1 2
S1 x y z
0 1 2
S2 a b c


Join & Split
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join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
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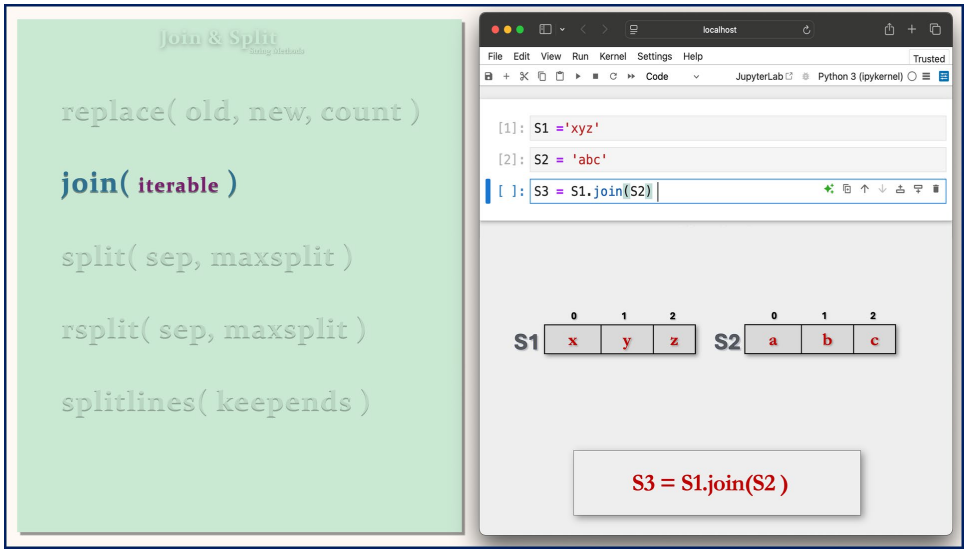
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 ='xyz'
[2]: S2 = 'abc'
[ ]:
S1 x y z
S2 a b c
S3 = S1.join(S2)


Join & Split
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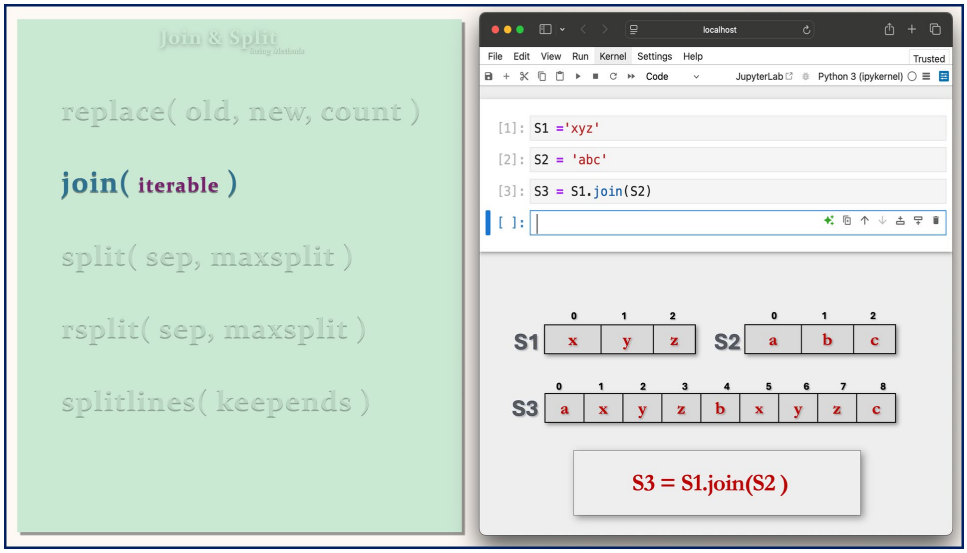
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 ='xyz'
[2]: S2 = 'abc'
[ ]: S3 = S1.join(S2)
S1 x y z
S2 a b c
S3 = S1.join(S2)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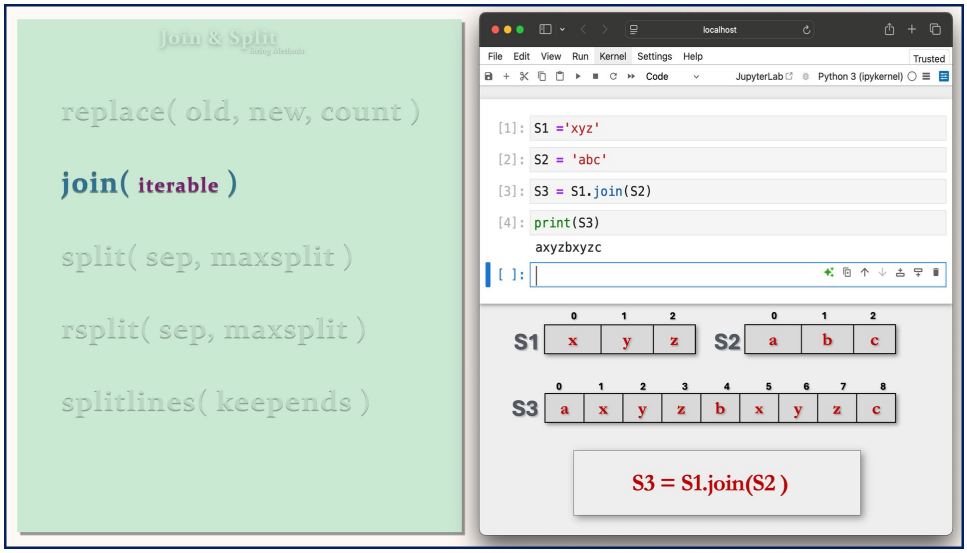
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 ='xyz'
[2]: S2 = 'abc'
[3]: S3 = S1.join(S2)
[ ]:
S1
S2
S3
S3 = S1.join(S2)


Join & Split
String Methods
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rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
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localhost
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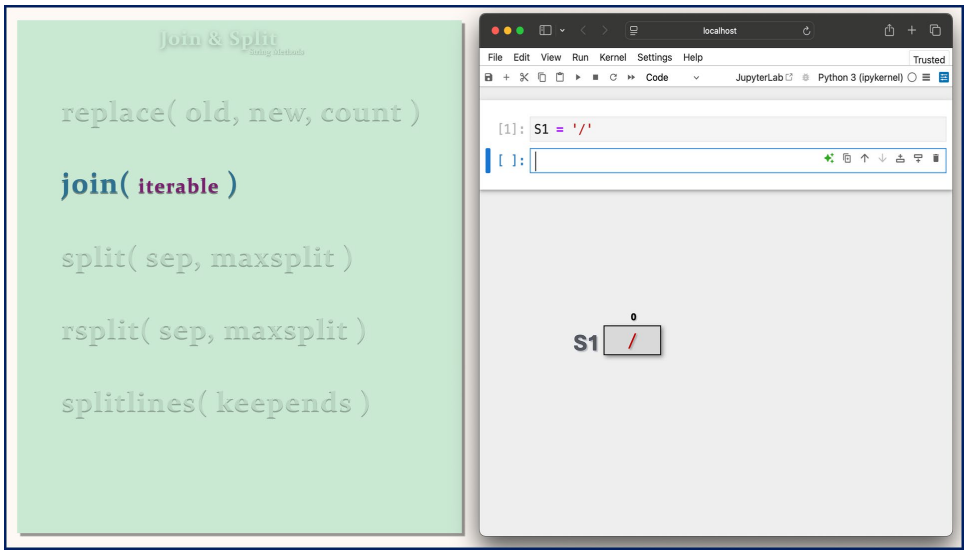
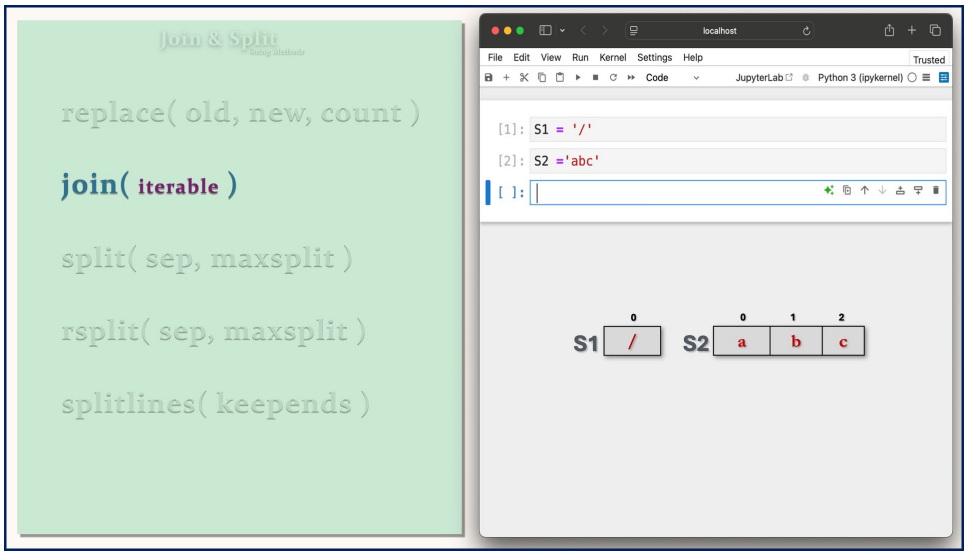
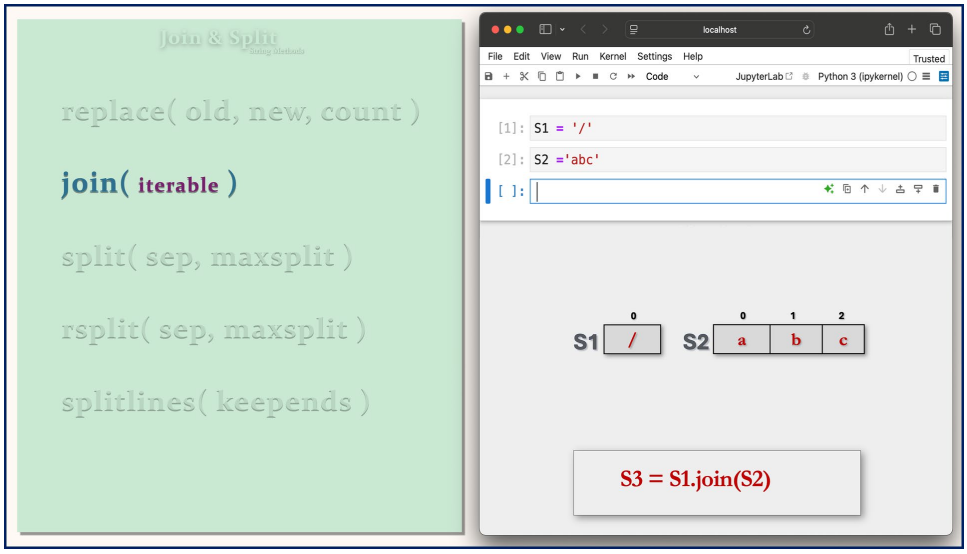
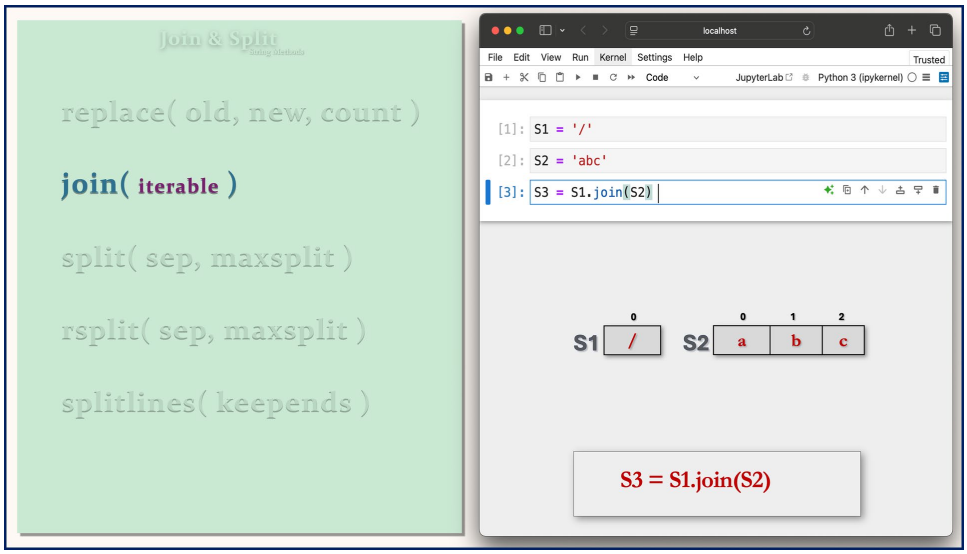
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 ='xyz'
[2]: S2 = 'abc'
[3]: S3 = S1.join(S2)
[4]: print(S3)
axyzbxyzc
[ ]:
S1
S2
S3
S3 = S1.join(S2)


Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = '/'
[ ]:
0
S1
/


Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = '/'
[2]: S2 ='abc'
[ ]:
0
S1
/
0 1 2
S2
a b c


Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = '/'
[2]: S2 ='abc'
[ ]:
0
S1
/
S2
0
1
2
a
b
c
S3 = S1.join(S2)


Join & Split
String Methods
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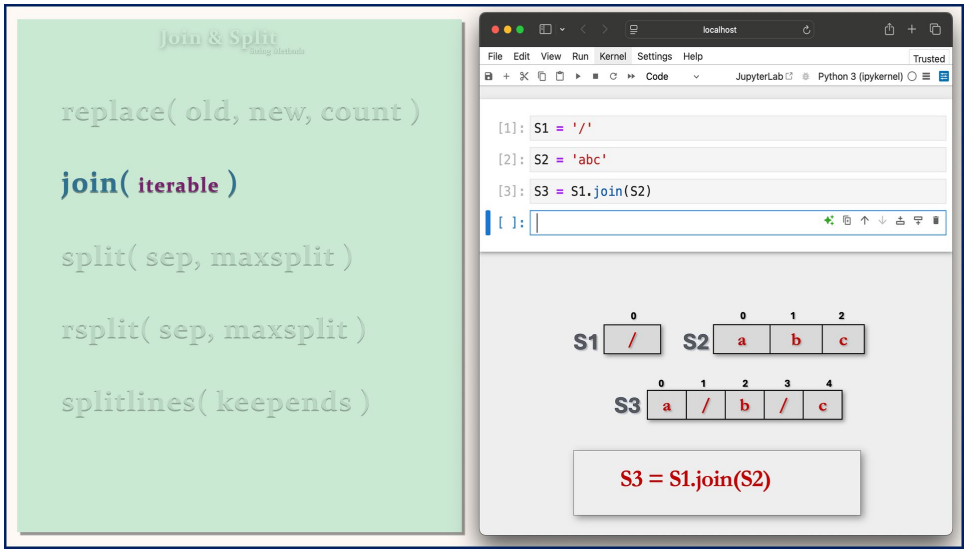
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = '/'
[2]: S2 = 'abc'
[3]: S3 = S1.join(S2)
S1 / S2 a b c
S3 = S1.join(S2)


Join & Split
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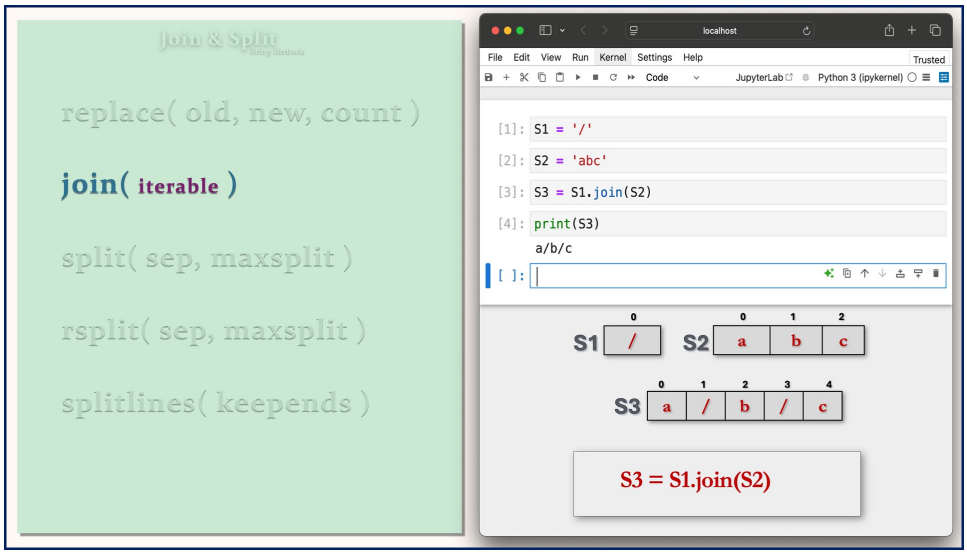
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = '/'
[2]: S2 = 'abc'
[3]: S3 = S1.join(S2)
[ ]:
S1 / S2 a b c
S3 a / b / c
S3 = S1.join(S2)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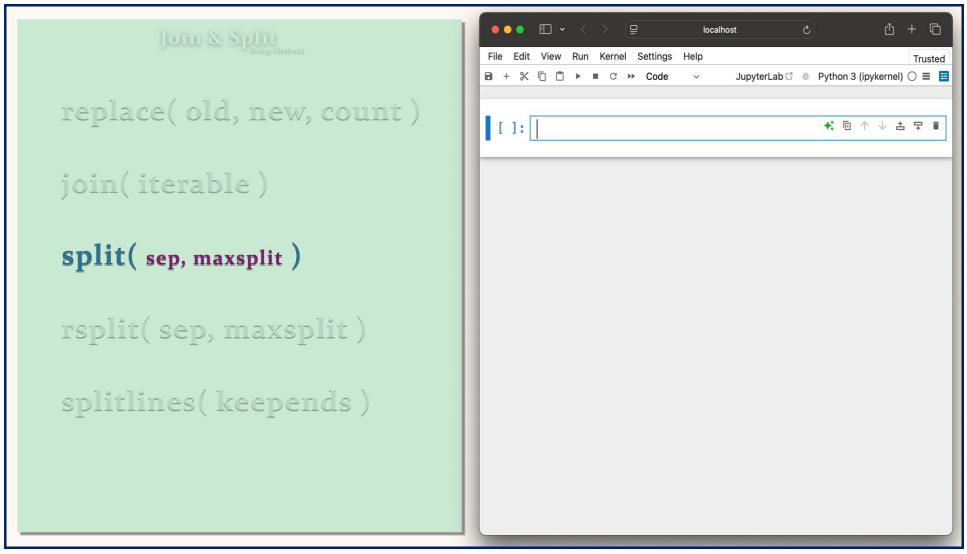
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = '/'
[2]: S2 = 'abc'
[3]: S3 = S1.join(S2)
[4]: print(S3)
a/b/c
[ ]:
S1
S2
S3
S3 = S1.join(S2)


Join & Split
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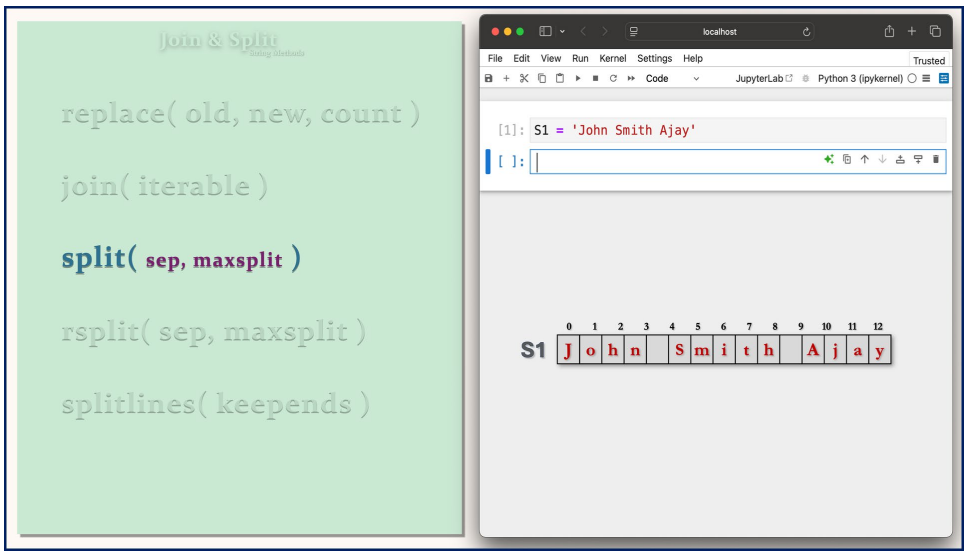
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[ ]:


Join & Split
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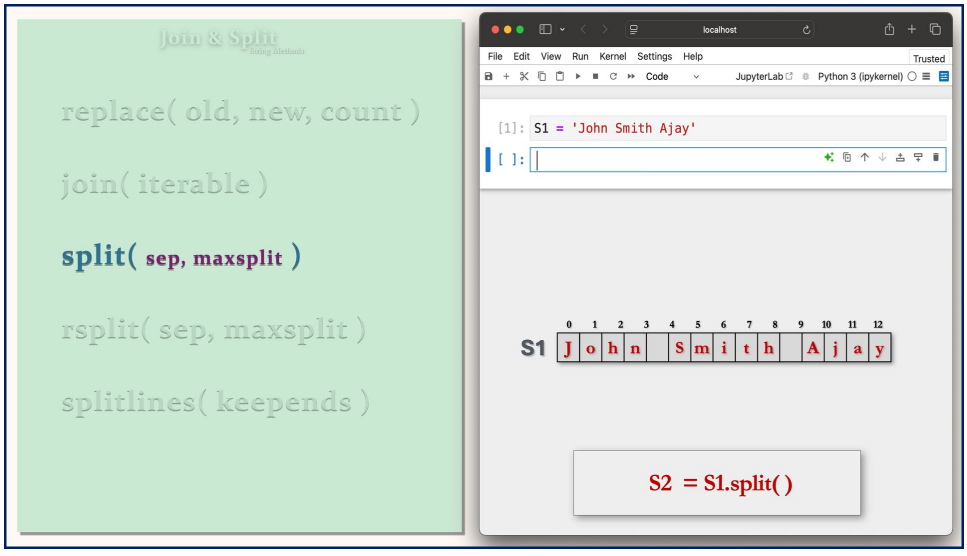
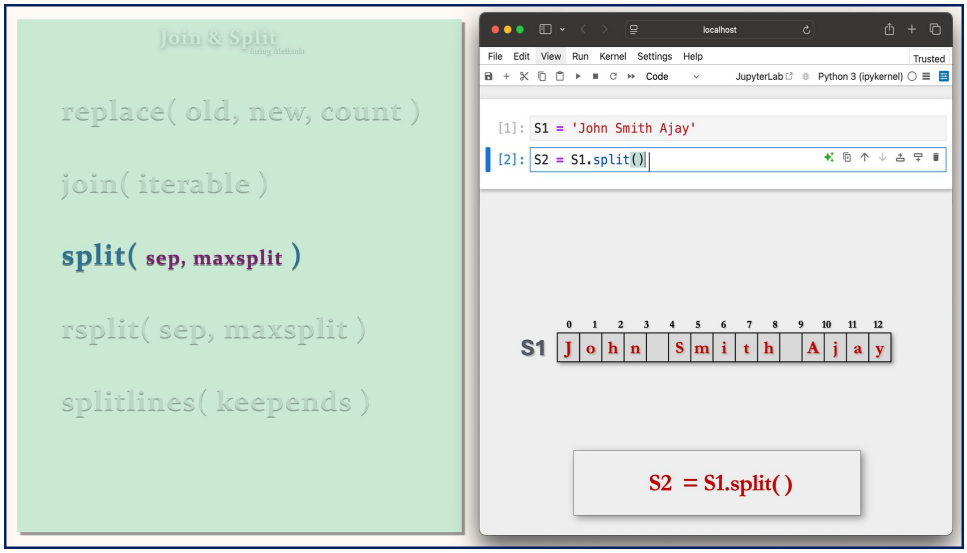
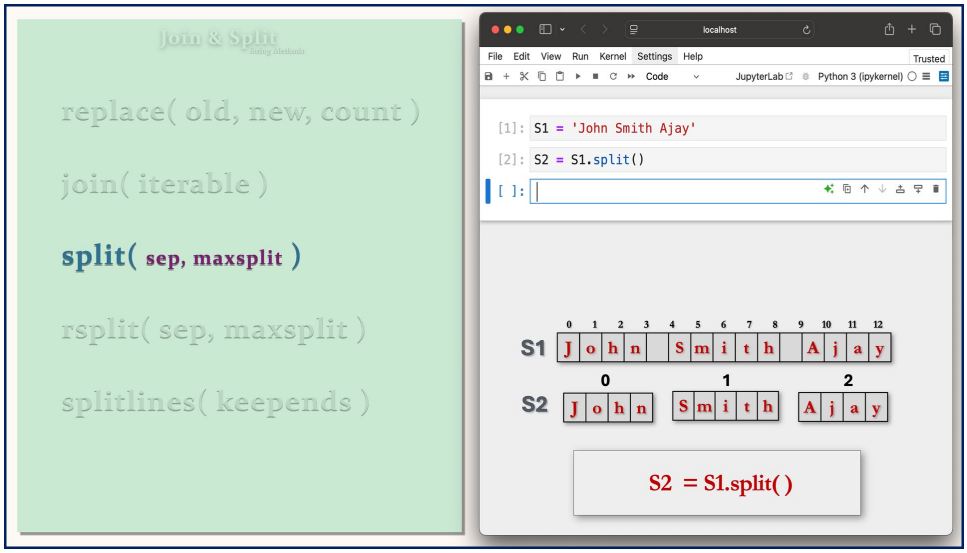
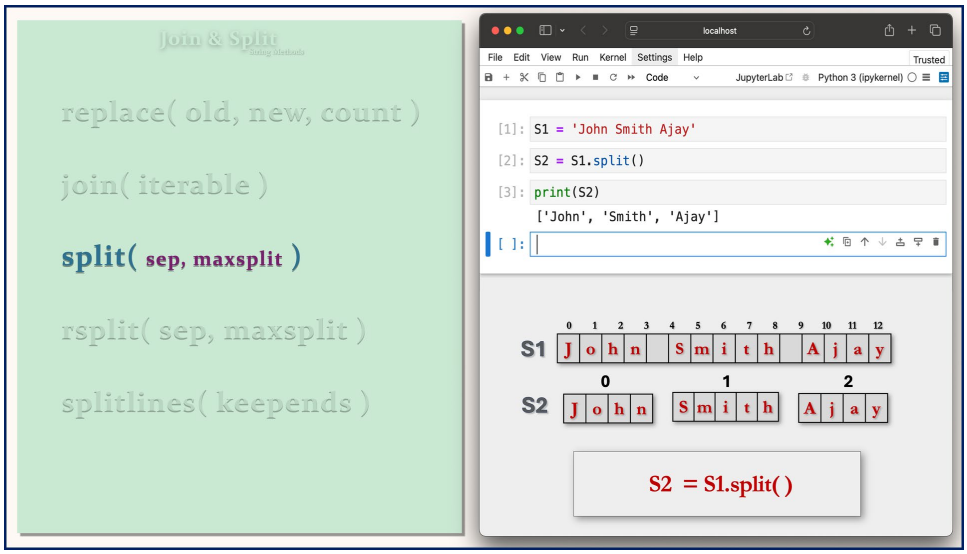
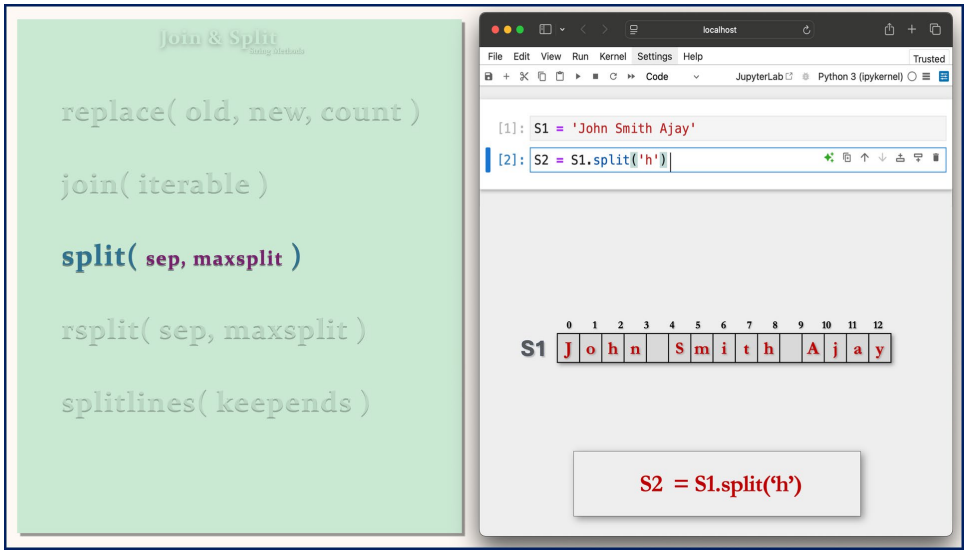
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John Smith Ajay'
[ ]:
S1
0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12
J o h n S m i t h A j a y

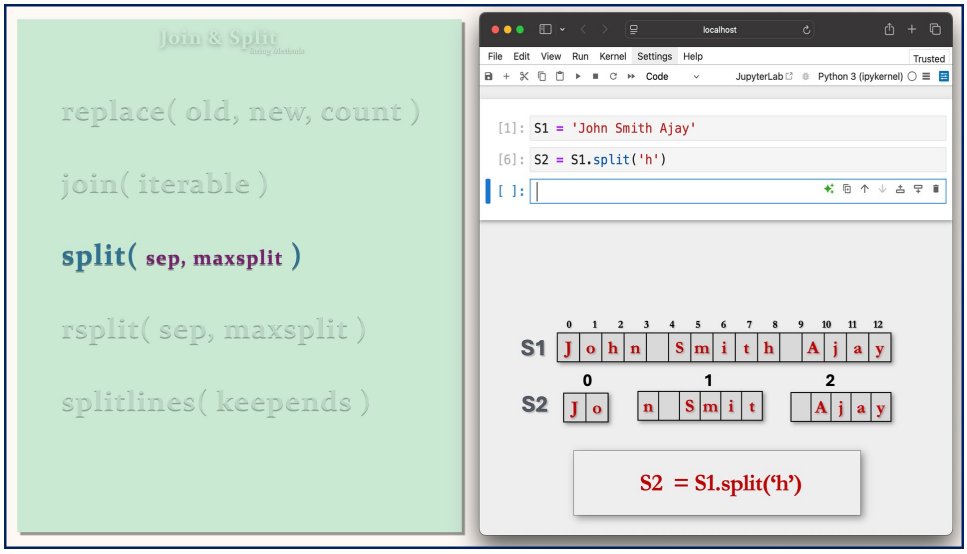

Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John Smith Ajay'
[ ]:
S1
0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12
J o h n S m i t h A j a y
S2 = S1.split( )

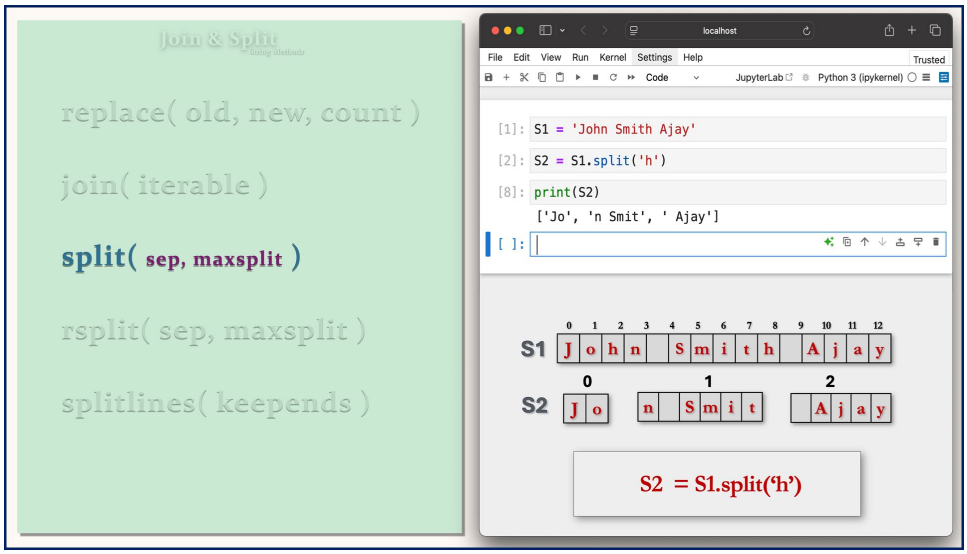

Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John Smith Ajay'
[2]: S2 = S1.split()
S1
J o h n S m i t h A j a y
0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12
S2 = S1.split( )

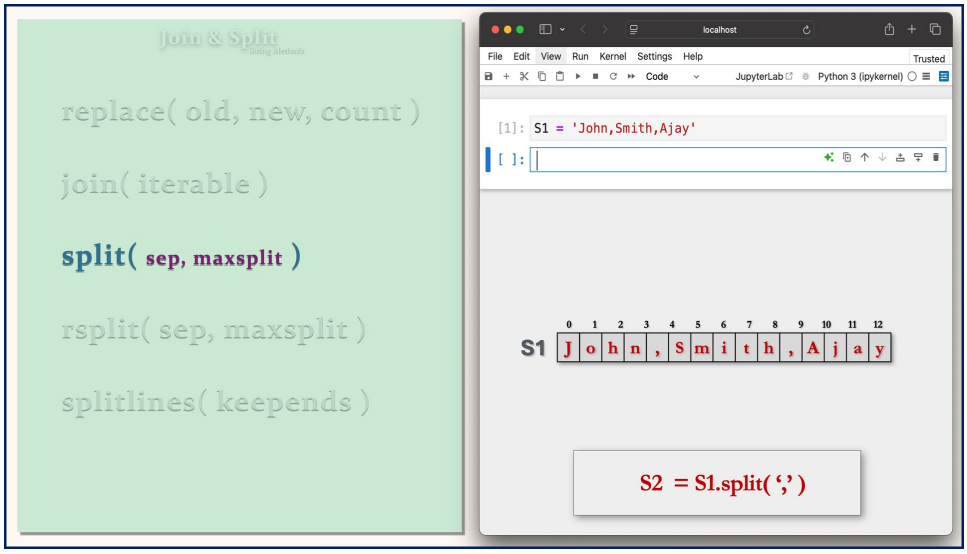

Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John Smith Ajay'
[2]: S2 = S1.split()
[ ]:
S1
J o h n S m i t h A j a y
0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12
S2
0
J o h n
1
S m i t h
2
A j a y
S2 = S1.split( )

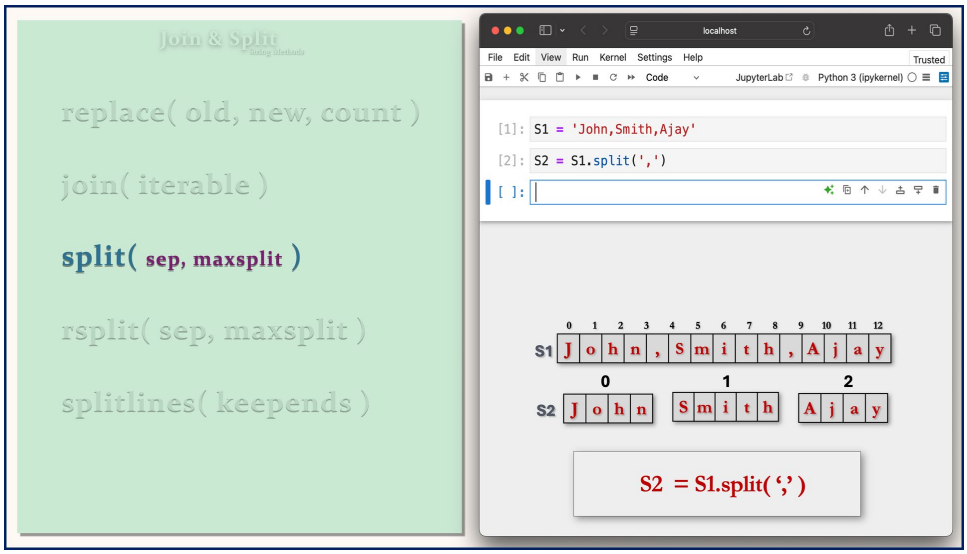

Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John Smith Ajay'
[2]: S2 = S1.split()
[3]: print(S2)
['John', 'Smith', 'Ajay']
[ ]:
S1
S2
S2 = S1.split( )


Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John Smith Ajay'
[2]: S2 = S1.split('h')
S1
S2 = S1.split('h')


Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John Smith Ajay'
[6]: S2 = S1.split('h')
[ ]:
S1
S2
S2 = S1.split('h')


Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John Smith Ajay'
[2]: S2 = S1.split('h')
[8]: print(S2)
['Jo', 'n Smit', ' Ajay']
[ ]:
S1
S2
S2 = S1.split('h')


Join & Split
String Methods
replace(old, new, count)
join(iterable)
split(sep, maxsplit)
rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
File Edit View Run Kernel Settings Help
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John,Smith,Ajay'
[ ]:
S1
S2 = S1.split(',')


Join & Split
String Methods
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rsplit(sep, maxsplit)
splitlines(keepends)
localhost
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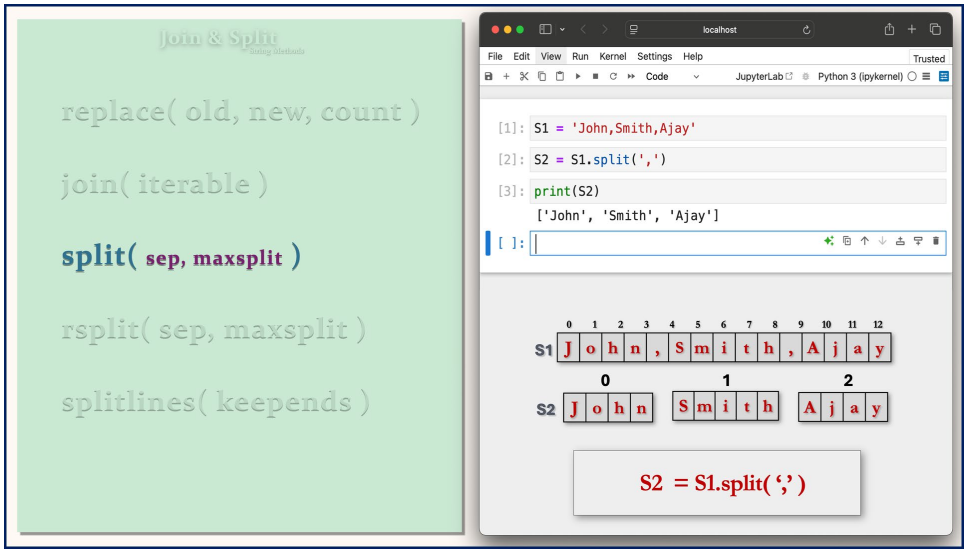
Trusted
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John,Smith,Ajay'
[2]: S2 = S1.split(',')
[ ]:
S1 J o h n , S m i t h , A j a y
S2 J o h n | S m i t h | A j a y
S2 = S1.split(',')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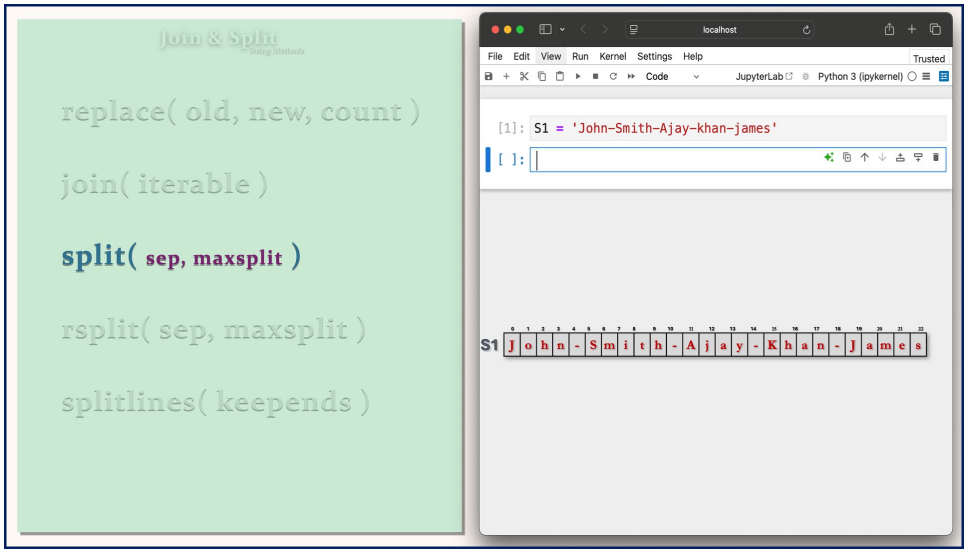
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John,Smith,Ajay'
[2]: S2 = S1.split(',')
[3]: print(S2)
['John', 'Smith', 'Ajay']
[ ]:
S1 J o h n , S m i t h , A j a y
S2 J o h n | S m i t h | A j a y
S2 = S1.split(',')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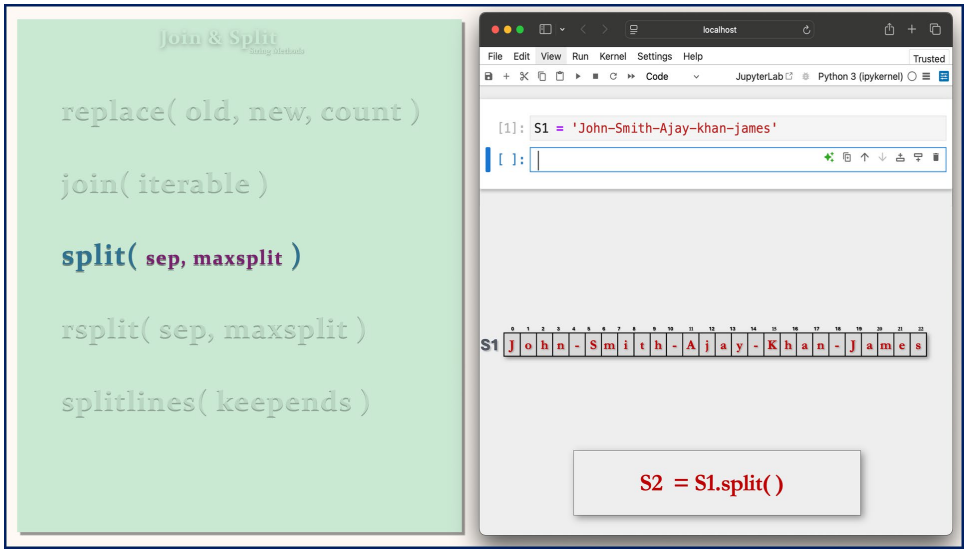
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james'
[ ]:
S1
John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james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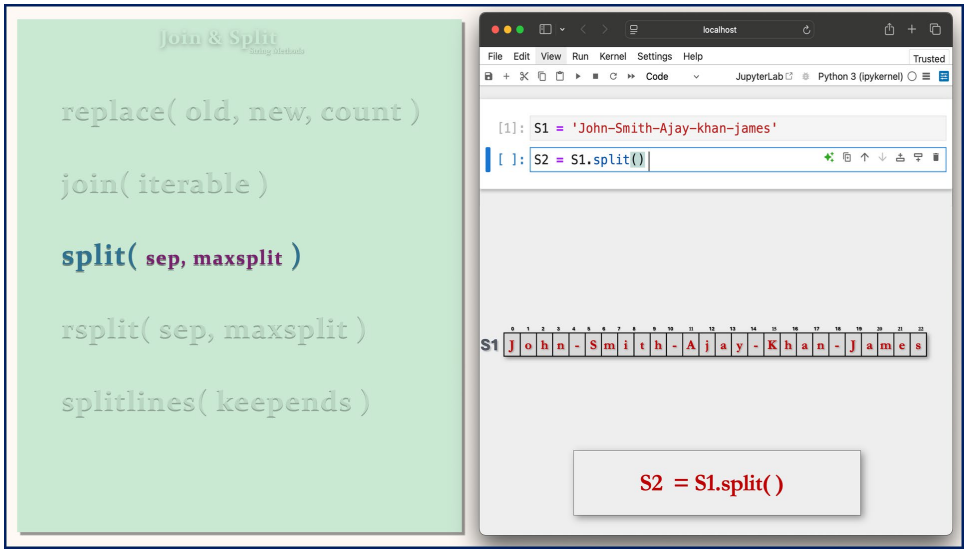
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james'
[ ]:
S1
John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james
S2 = S1.split( )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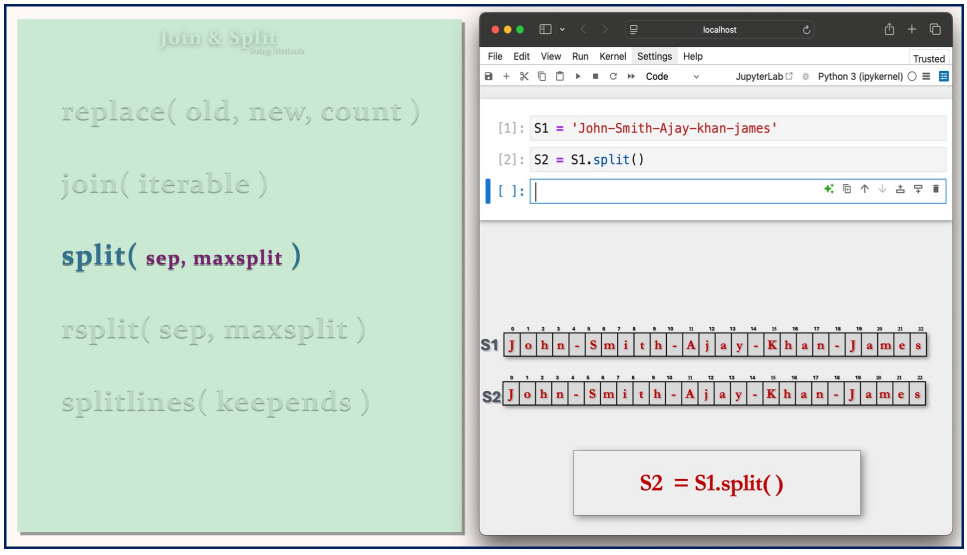
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james'
[ ]: S2 = S1.split()
S1
John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james
S2 = S1.split( )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S1
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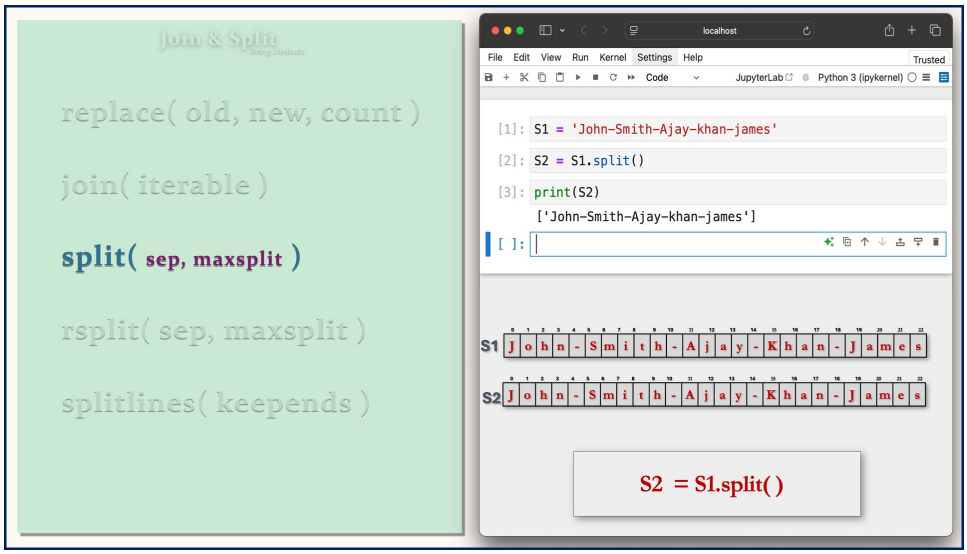
S2
John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james
S2 = S1.split( )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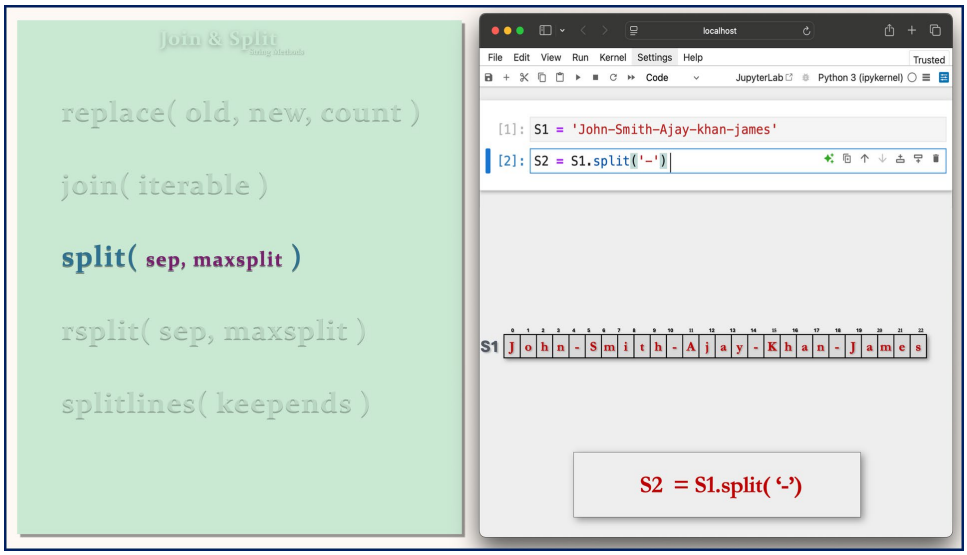
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james'
[2]: S2 = S1.split()
[3]: print(S2)
['John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james']
[ ]:
S1 John-Smith-Ajay-Khan-James
S2 John-Smith-Ajay-Khan-James
S2 = S1.split( )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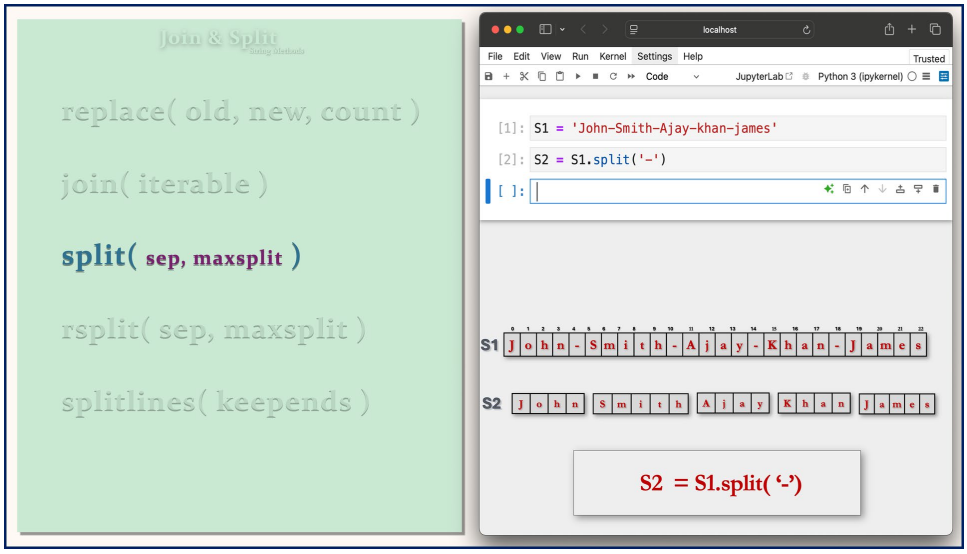
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james'
[2]: S2 = S1.split('-')
S1 John-Smith-Ajay-Khan-James
S2 = S1.split('-')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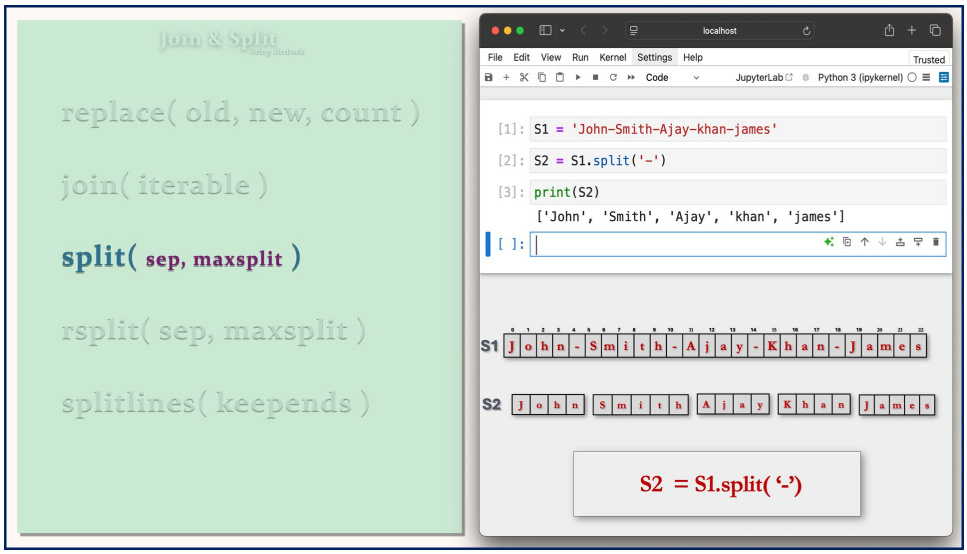
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james'
[2]: S2 = S1.split('-')
[ ]:
S1
S2
S2 = S1.split('-')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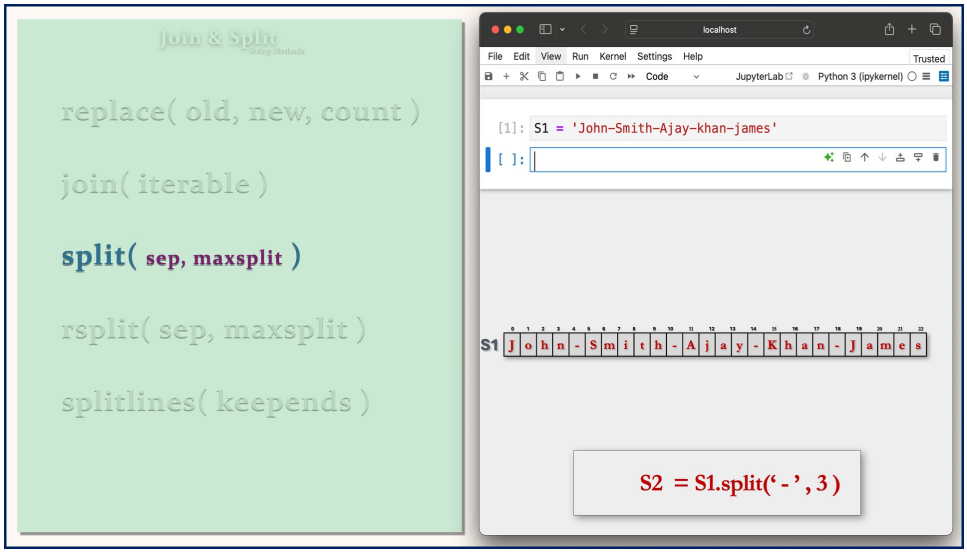
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james'
[2]: S2 = S1.split('-')
[3]: print(S2)
['John', 'Smith', 'Ajay', 'khan', 'james']
[ ]:
S1 John-Smith-Ajay-Khan-James
S2 John Smith Ajay Khan James
S2 = S1.split('-')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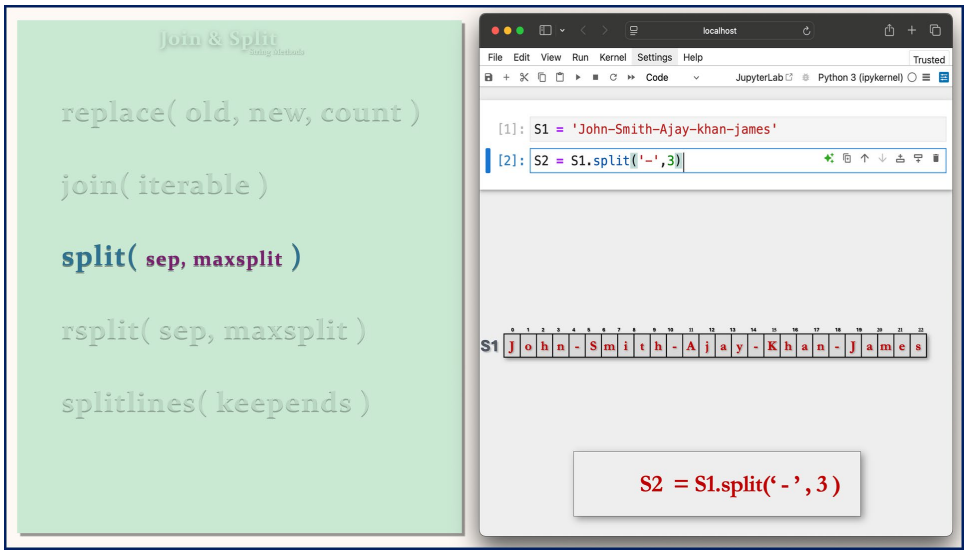
Code
JupyterLab
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james'
[ ]:
S1 John-Smith-Ajay-Khan-James
S2 = S1.split(' - ' , 3)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Code
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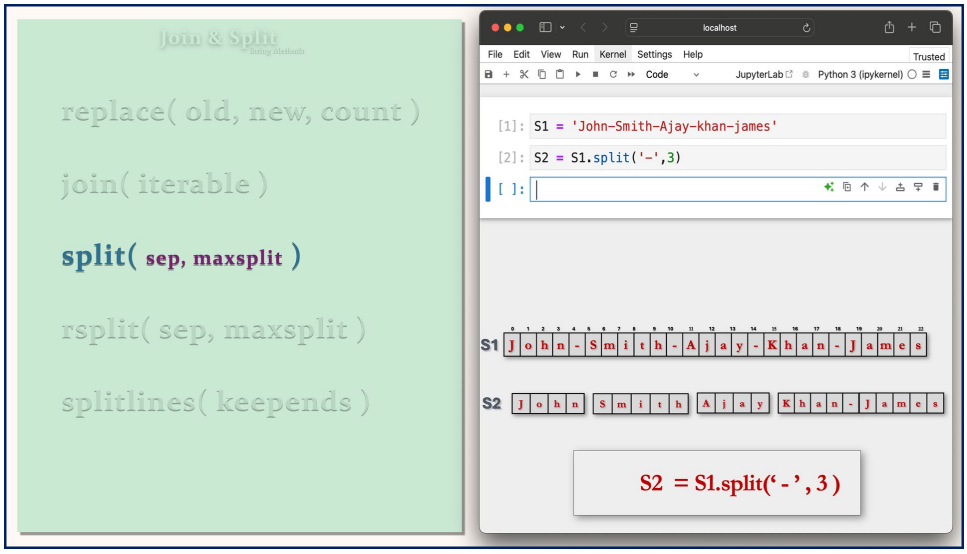
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james'
[2]: S2 = S1.split('-',3)
S1 John-Smith-Ajay-Khan-James
S2 = S1.split(' - ', 3)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Code
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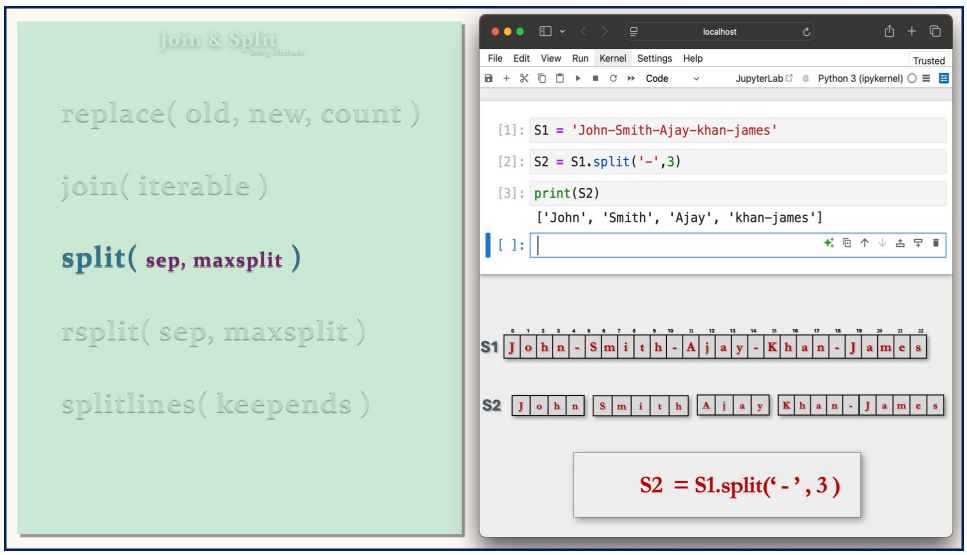
Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james'
[2]: S2 = S1.split('-',3)
[ ]:
S1 John-Smith-Ajay-Khan-James
S2 John Smith Ajay Khan-James
S2 = S1.split(' - ', 3)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Python 3 (ipykernel)
[1]: S1 = 'John-Smith-Ajay-khan-james'
[2]: S2 = S1.split('-',3)
[3]: print(S2)
['John', 'Smith', 'Ajay', 'khan-james']
[ ]:
S1
S2
S2 = S1.split(' - ', 3)